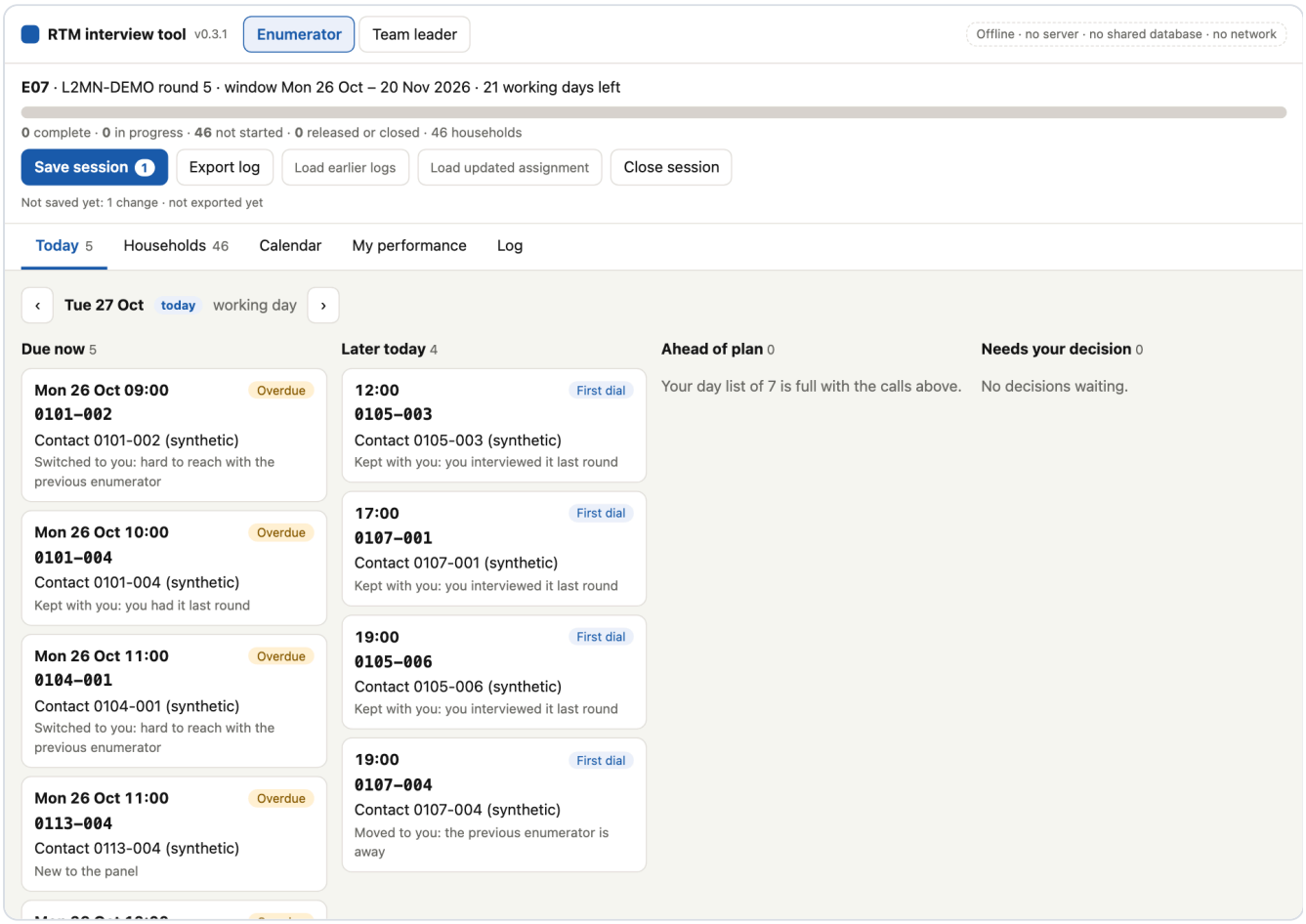
RTM interview tool

User manual for enumerators and team leaders
Assignment, scheduling and call logs for phone panel surveys



Tool version 0.3.1 · Manual of 1 November 2026
Real-Time Monitoring (RTM) Handbook task team. Every picture in this manual shows the synthetic practice program “L2MN-DEMO”: no real household, name or phone number appears anywhere in it.

Contents

Introduction

1 What the tool does

2 Files and folders

3 A round at a glance

4 Before you start

Part A · Enumerator

A1 Open your assignment

A2 The screen at a glance

A3 The Today tab

A4 A household's panel

A5 Make a call

A6 Log the result

A7 Booked callbacks

A8 A complete under 3 minutes

A9 Log a call made earlier

A10 Correct or void an entry

A11 Release, switch or removal

A12 Add or correct a number

A13 Replacements

A14 The Households tab

A15 The Calendar tab

A16 My performance

A17 The Log tab

A18 Save, close and continue

A19 Export your log

A20 An updated assignment

A21 On a phone

A22 Good practice and messages

Part B · Team leader

B1 Start or continue a session

B2 The Prepare tab

B3 Step 1 · Household list

B4 Step 2 · Earlier rounds

B5 Step 3 · Replacement list

B6 Step 4 · Round calendar

B7 Step 5 · Team

B8 Step 6 · Assignment rule

B9 Step 7 · Check the assignment

B10 Step 8 · Write and give out the files

B11 Save and close the session

B12 Import the exports

B13 Merge questions and the merge report

B14 New or corrected numbers

B15 Progress

B16 Call log and the round's files

B17 Analytics

B18 Risk lists

B19 A round, step by step

B20 Messages and what to do

Part C · With KoBoToolbox, a call-center system, Survey Solutions and a calling service

C1 When this part applies

C2 A form that records each call attempt

C3 A call-center system's log and the interview form

C4 A form the tool does not know

C5 A round, day by day

C6 Survey Solutions and a calling service

C7 What the leader sees

Reference

R1 Call results

R2 Why a household is with an enumerator

R3 Every file the tool reads or writes

Introduction

1 What the tool does

The RTM interview tool is one web page, `rtm_interview_tool.html`, that runs in a web browser on the enumerator's or the leader's own computer. It has two views, chosen with the buttons at the top of the page:

- **Enumerator.** Each enumerator opens the assignment file their leader gave them, works through the calls that are due, logs every dial with its time and result, saves their session, and exports their log.
- **Team leader.** The leader prepares each round: they assign households to enumerators, plan each household's first dial, and write one assignment file per enumerator. During and after the round, they import the enumerators' exports, settle any merge question, and read progress, the merged call log, the round's analytics and the risk lists.

> **Offline by design.** The page has no server, no shared database and no network connection. The browser is told to refuse every request from it. It reads only the files you open and writes only the files you save or export. Nothing leaves your computer unless you move a file yourself.

The tool follows the handbook's practice. The default way of assigning households keeps the same enumerator, rotates a planned share of households each round, and switches the enumerator for a household that becomes hard to reach (Section 3.5.3). Each household's first dial is planned at the hour of its last interview (Section 3.5.2), early in the round's window (Section 3.4). The definitions of a dial, a complete and an enumerator-day are those of Box 3.0.

2 Files and folders

Because nothing is shared over a network, the work moves in files. Three kinds of folder keep them apart:

Folder	Who can read it	What goes in it
The enumerator's own folder	That enumerator and the leader	The enumerator's assignment file, and their saved sessions
The common folder	The whole team	The enumerators' exported logs (`.csv` and `.json`). They hold household IDs, times and results, but no names or phone numbers
The leader's own folder	The leader	The household list, the leader's session, the round's manifest and outputs, contacts files

> **Contact information never goes in the common folder.** An assignment file holds names and phone numbers, but only that enumerator's own households. A contacts file, written when an enumerator adds or corrects a number, goes to the leader directly. The leader's session file holds the whole household list.

3 A round at a glance

1. **The leader prepares the round** (Part B, steps 1 to 8): household list, earlier rounds, replacements, calendar, team, rule. The tool writes one assignment file per enumerator and a manifest of the round.
2. **The leader gives each enumerator their own file**, through a folder only that enumerator can read, with its passphrase if the file is protected.
3. **Enumerators call and log** (Part A). They save their session whenever they stop, and export their log at the end of each day.
4. **The leader imports the exports** whenever they want to see progress, and settles the merge questions.
5. **At the end of the round**, the leader imports the final exports and writes the round's files: the merged call log, `interviews.csv` and `calendar.csv` for the handbook's round template, and the merge report.

4 Before you start

- **Browser.** Open the page in Google Chrome, for example by dragging the file onto a Chrome window. Chrome was used for all the tool's tests. Edge, Firefox and Safari should work but have not been tested. In Chrome a save can overwrite the same file; in Firefox and Safari each save downloads a new file with the time in its name.
- **Practice files.** The folder `samples/` holds the synthetic program L2MN-DEMO used in this manual: assignment files for round 5 in `samples/round05/`, and the leader's inputs and the enumerators' exports in `samples/leader/`. Phone numbers there use the invalid country code +000.
- **Clock.** The tool records times from the computer's clock. Keep it set to the right date, time and time zone.

Part A · Enumerator

Opening an assignment, calling, logging, saving and exporting

A1 Open your assignment

Your team leader gives you an assignment file, named like `E07_assignment_R05.json` (your enumerator ID and the round). It lists your households for the round, with their phone numbers, their history and the plan for each one's first dial.

1. Open `rtm_interview_tool.html`. The **Enumerator** view opens.
2. Click **Open my assignment file** and choose your file.
3. If the file is protected, the tool asks for its passphrase. Type the passphrase your leader gave you and click **Open**. The passphrase is used only on your computer and is not stored.

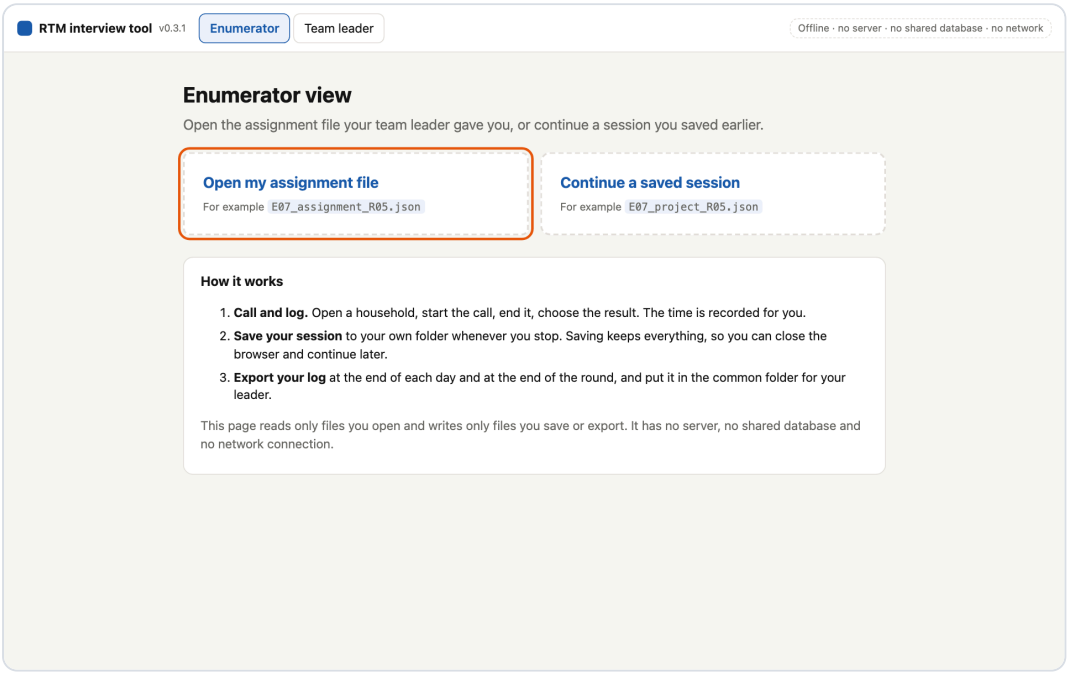


Figure A1. The start page. Open your assignment file the first time; later, continue the session you saved.

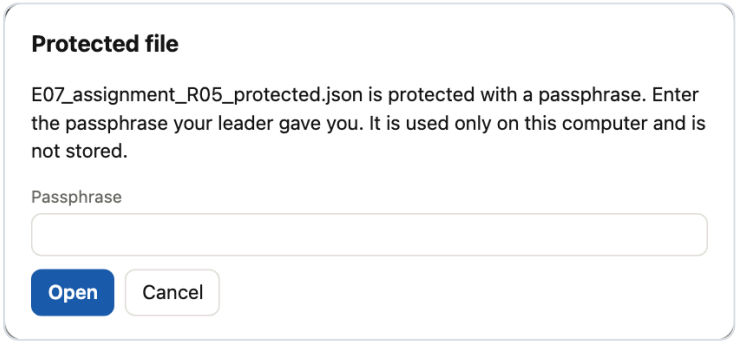


Figure A2. A protected assignment file asks for its passphrase.

To carry on where you stopped, use **Continue a saved session** instead (A18).

A2 The screen at a glance

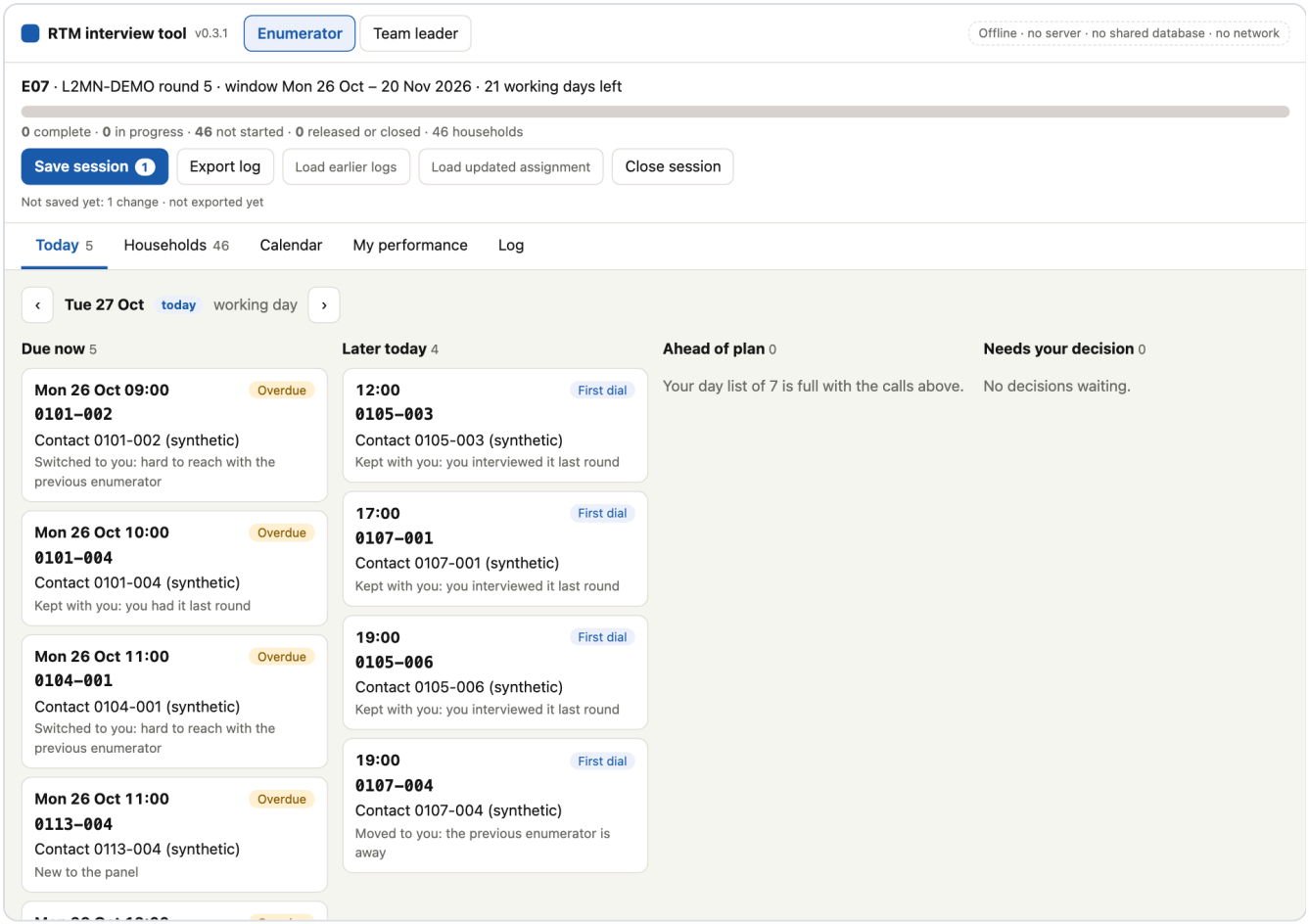


Figure A3. The enumerator's screen after opening an assignment: the summary at the top, the tabs, and today's calls.

The summary at the top gives your enumerator ID, the program and round, the round's window and the working days left. The bar shows the share of your households completed. Under it are the main buttons:

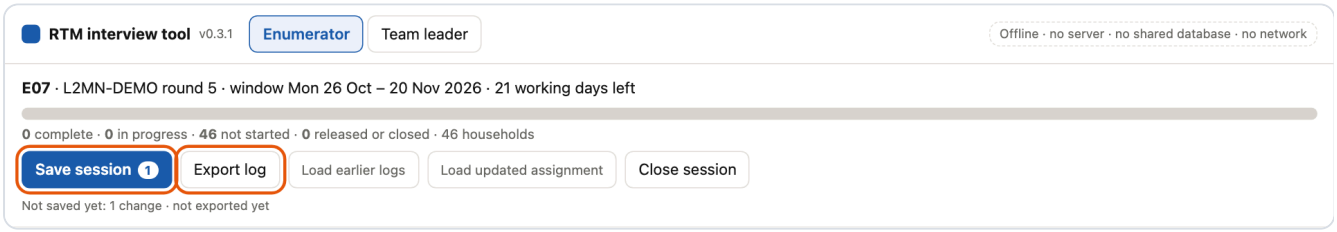


Figure A4. The summary and the main buttons. The number on **Save session** counts the changes not yet saved.

Button	What it does	See
Save session	Saves everything you logged into one file in your own folder, so you can close the browser and continue later	A18
Export log	Writes your call log as a CSV and a JSON file for the common folder	A19
Load earlier logs	Adds your exports from earlier rounds, to compare your performance	A16
Load updated assignment	Opens a new version of your assignment for the same round, keeping what you logged	A20

Close session	Closes the round on this screen; with unsaved changes it offers to save first	A18

The line under the buttons says when you last saved and exported. The tabs below lead to **Today**, **Households**, **Calendar**, **My performance** and **Log**.

A3 The Today tab

The Today tab lists the calls to make, in four columns:

- **Due now:** calls whose time has come, including overdue ones from earlier days.
- **Later today:** calls planned for later in the day, in time order.
- **Ahead of plan:** when fewer households are due or planned today than your leader's **day list** holds (the number is given under the columns), households planned for later days, soonest first, so that unanswered calls do not leave you waiting. Work through them once the calls due are done; a booked callback is never pulled forward.
- **Needs your decision:** households where the next step is not a call, such as a hard refusal to release or a household with no working number.

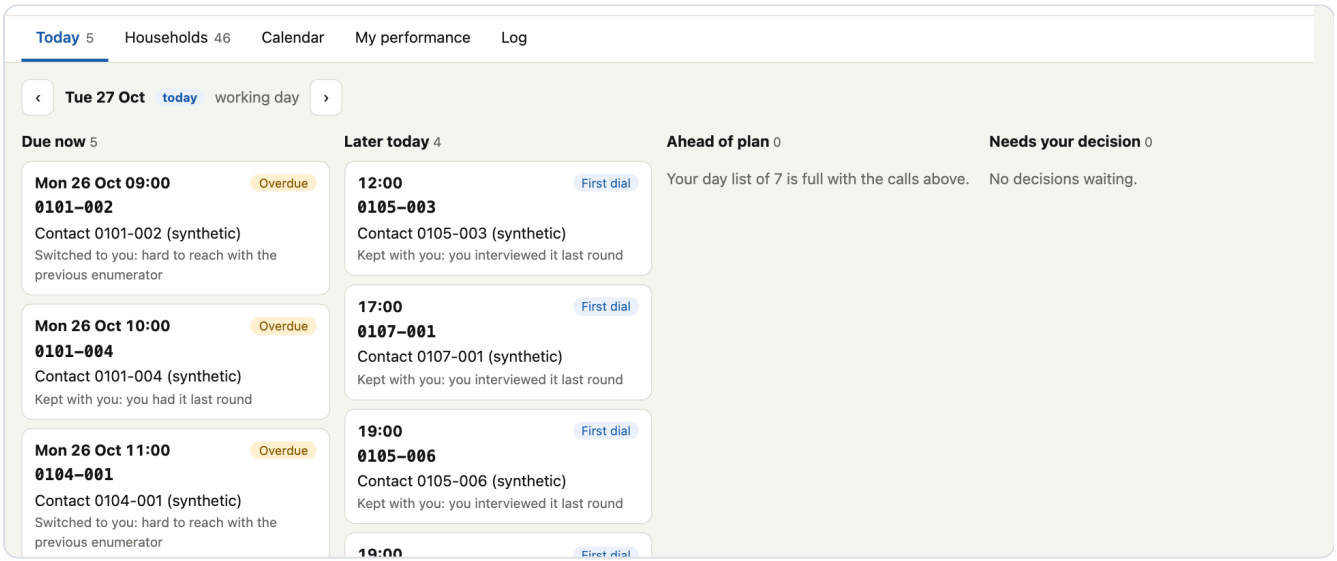


Figure A5. The tabs and the first two columns. Each card shows the planned time, the household ID and contact, and why it is with you or what happened last.

A label on each card says what kind of call it is: **First dial**, **Redial**, **Callback** (an agreed time) or **Overdue**. Use the arrows beside the date to look at another day. Click a card to open the household.

A4 A household's panel

Clicking a household opens its panel on the right. From the top:

- **State and reason:** not started, in progress, complete, and so on, and why the household is with you (R2). **Why is this household with me?** explains the rule your leader used.
- **Next:** the tool's suggestion for the next call, with its time. It says “overdue since” when the time has passed.
- **Usual time:** the hour of the household's last interview, or the hour your leader planned.

- **Last interview** and **last three rounds:** each round's number with a filled dot if the household was interviewed and an empty dot if not; a dash means the household had not joined the panel yet.
- **In the panel since**, **first dial planned** and the **sampling unit** (PSU and stratum).

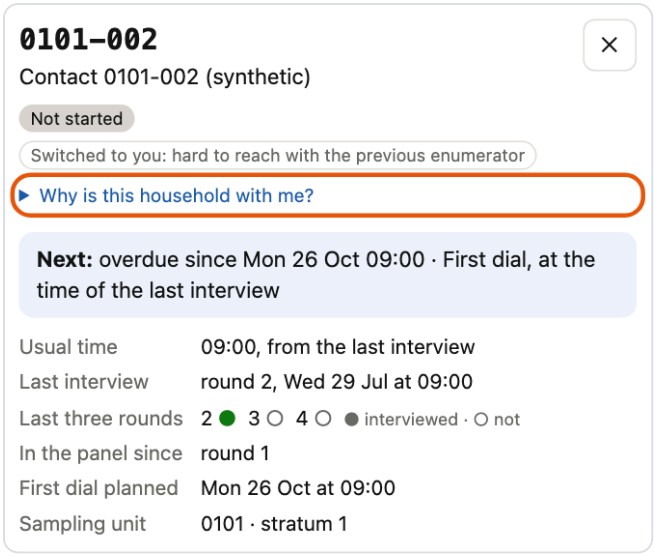


Figure A6. The top of a household's panel.

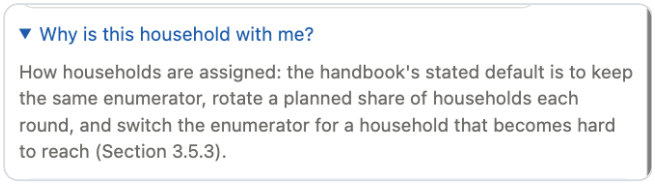


Figure A7. "Why is this household with me?", opened.

A5 Make a call

1. In **Phone numbers**, find the number to call. **Copy** puts it on the clipboard. The line under each number says how its last dial went.
2. Click **Start call** by that number when you dial. A timer starts.
3. When the call ends, click **End call**. If no call was made after all, click **Cancel (no call made)**: nothing is logged.

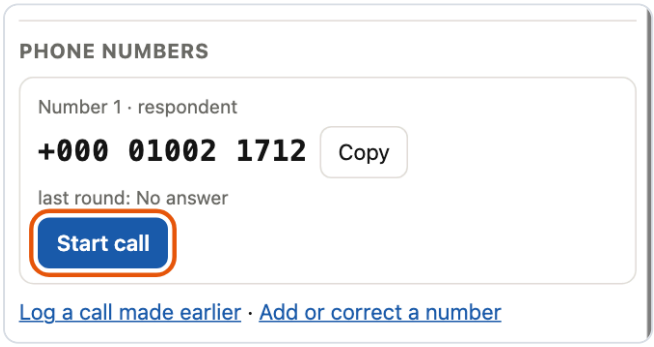


Figure A8. A household's number and the **Start call** button.

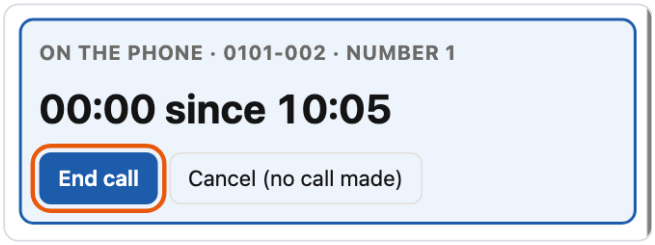


Figure A9. During the call: the timer and **End call**.

> The start and end times come from the clock, so the call's length is recorded for you. Box 3.0 uses these times: a complete needs at least 3 minutes, and dial minutes count toward productivity.

A6 Log the result

After **End call**, the result form opens.

1. Choose the **result of the call** (R1 lists them all). The coloured edge marks the kind: green for a complete, brown for a number problem, red for a refusal.
2. If the respondent agreed a time to call back, enter it in **Callback time**. It is required for “Appointment booked”.
3. In **After this call**, keep the default **Keep calling**, or choose **Release for this round** or **Ask for another enumerator next round**.
4. Add a short **note** if useful. Notes are operational only: never write personal details.
5. Click **Save call**. **Discard** drops the call without logging it.

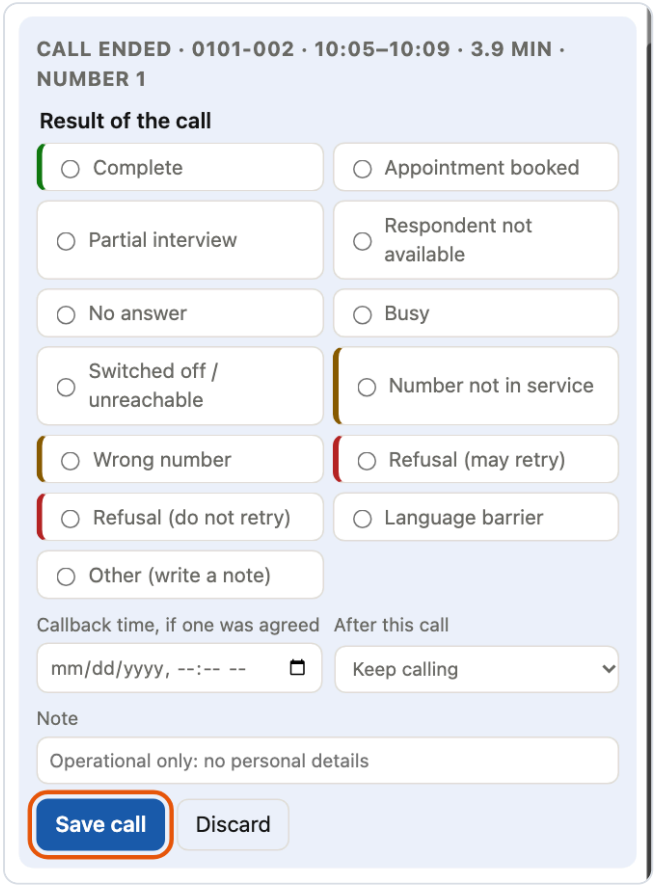


Figure A10. The result form after a call.

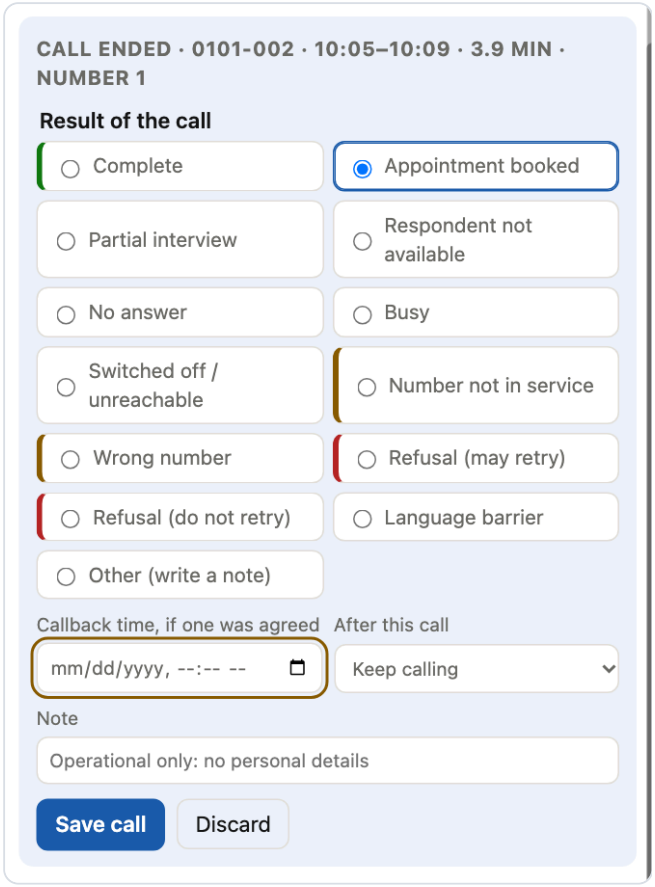


Figure A11. A missing entry is outlined and named in a message: here, the callback time for a booked appointment.

A7 Booked callbacks

A call saved with a callback time moves to that time. It appears in **Later today** (or on its day) with a **Callback** label, ahead of the tool's own suggestions.

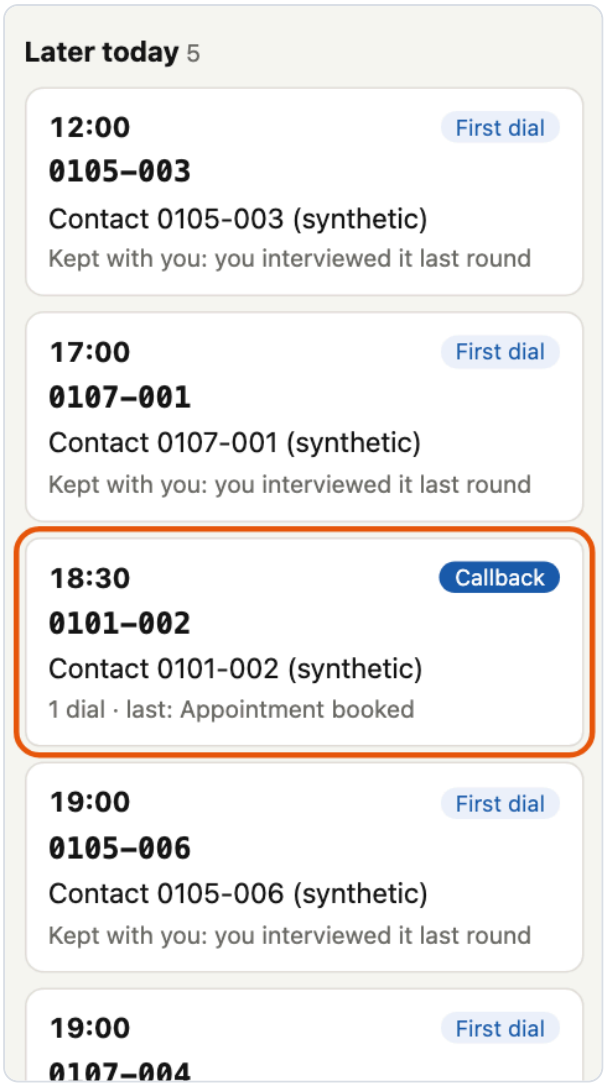


Figure A12. The booked callback at 18:30, in “Later today”.

Without a callback, the tool suggests the next call itself: the same day at least two hours after the last dial and within the call hours, or else the next working day near the household's usual hour.

A8 A complete under 3 minutes

Box 3.0 counts a complete only when the interview lasted at least 3 minutes. A shorter one counts as an appointment contact, so the household stays open and the tool tells you why.

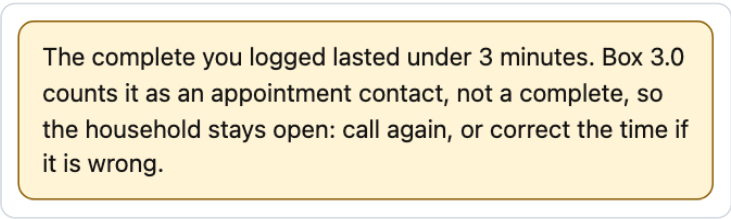


Figure A13. A complete that lasted 2 minutes: call again, or correct the time if it is wrong (A10).

A9 Log a call made earlier

If you made a call without the timer, for example on another phone, use **Log a call made earlier** under the phone numbers. Enter which number, when the call started and how many minutes it lasted, then the result as in A6. The log keeps both the call's own time and the time you entered it.

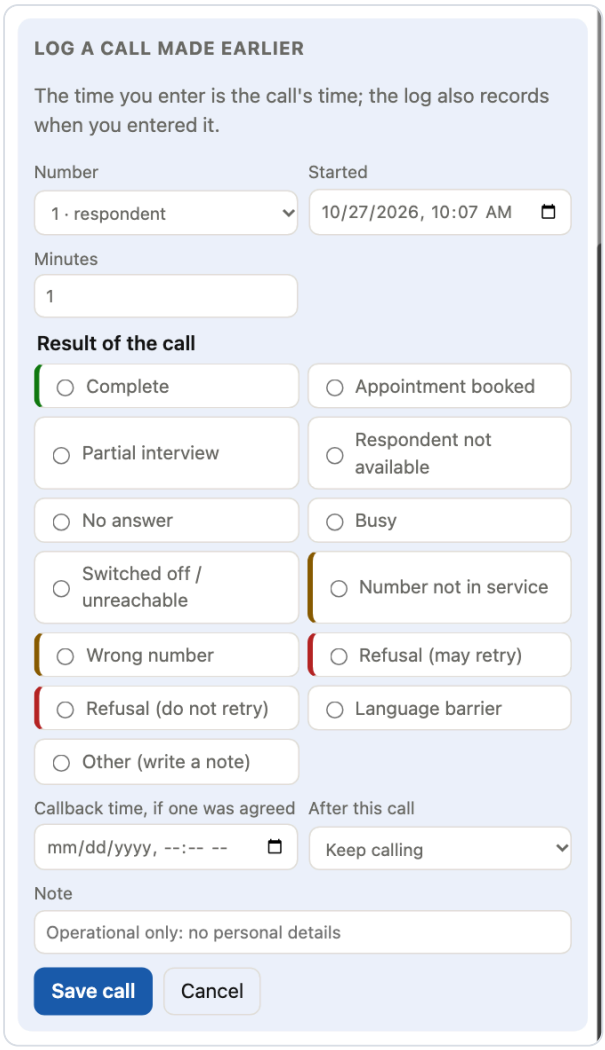


Figure A14. Logging a call made earlier.

A10 Correct or void an entry

Nothing in the log is ever deleted. To fix a mistake, find the call under **Calls this round** and click **Correct or void**:

- change the result, the number, the start time, the minutes, the callback time or the note; or
- tick **Void this entry** if the call was logged by mistake.

Write **why** you are correcting it (required) and click **Save correction**. The original entry stays in the log, marked as corrected or voided. An action such as a release is undone the same way, with **Undo**.

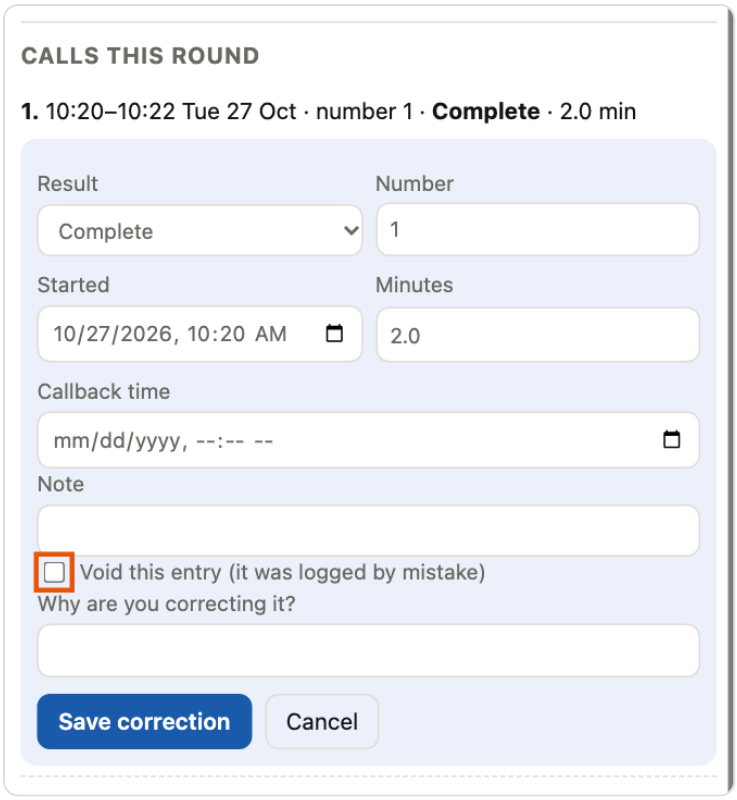


Figure A15. Correcting a logged call. The tick box voids it instead.

A11 Release, switch or removal

The **Actions** at the bottom of a household's panel are case actions, not call results:

- **Release for this round:** stop calling the household this round. It stays in the panel and is called again next round (the handbook's rule is to release, never delete; Section 3.3.5). The reason is optional.
- **Ask for another enumerator:** ask your leader to give the household to someone else next round, for example after a poor contact. Your leader decides.
- **Ask the leader to remove:** only when no number works, or the household has no number at all. Your leader decides.

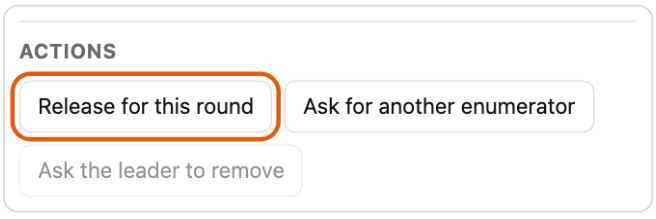


Figure A16. A household's actions.

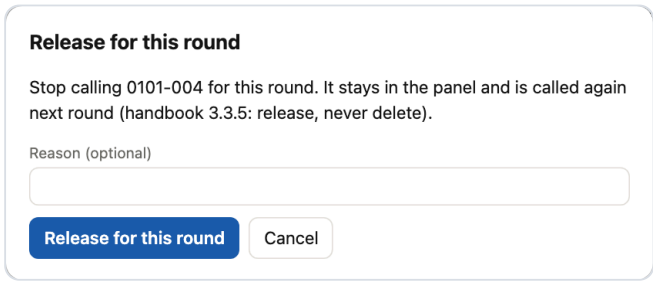


Figure A17. Releasing a household for the round.

A12 Add or correct a number

If a respondent gives a new number, or a number is wrong, click **Add or correct a number**. Choose which number (or a new one) and whether you correct it or mark it as not working, type the number and whose it

is, and click **Save number**. The new number can be dialled at once. It goes to your leader in a separate contacts file when you export (A19), never in the log for the common folder.

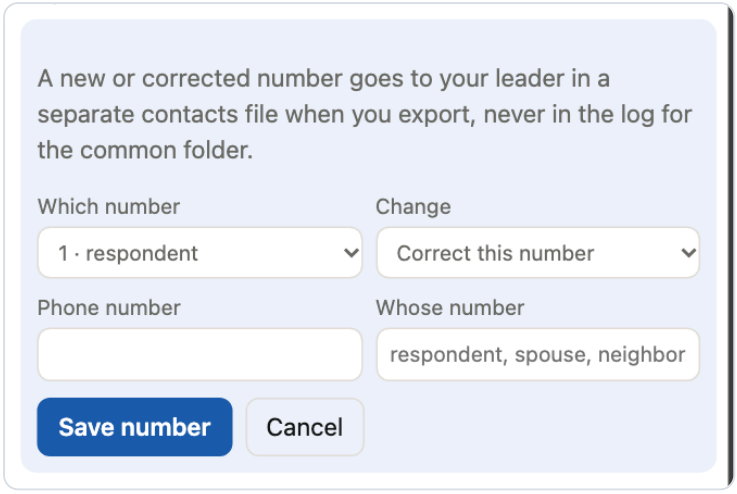


Figure A18. Adding or correcting a phone number.

A13 Replacements

Some households come with replacement households, listed in their panel in the order the sample was drawn. A replacement can be used only when the round's rules allow it, by default after a hard refusal or when no number works. Then:

1. Click **Activate the next replacement**.
2. Write why (required) and confirm. The replacement becomes a household to call, and the original household is closed for the round.

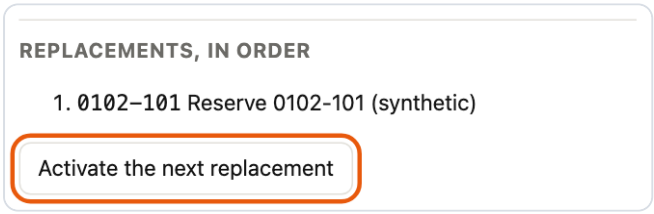


Figure A19. After a hard refusal, the next replacement can be activated.

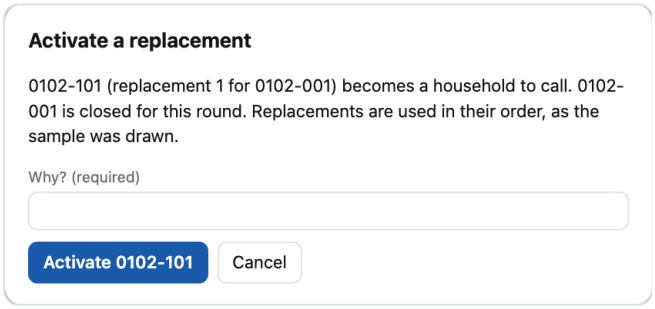


Figure A20. Confirming a replacement, with the reason.

When the button is greyed out, the line beside it says why, for example that replacements are allowed only after a hard refusal or when no number works.

A14 The Households tab

The Households tab lists all your households in a table: their contact, why each is with you, the first dial planned, the number of dials, the last result, the next step and the state. Use the filters above it (open, not started, in progress, complete, released or closed, needs the leader, all) and the search box for an ID or a name. Click a row to open the household.

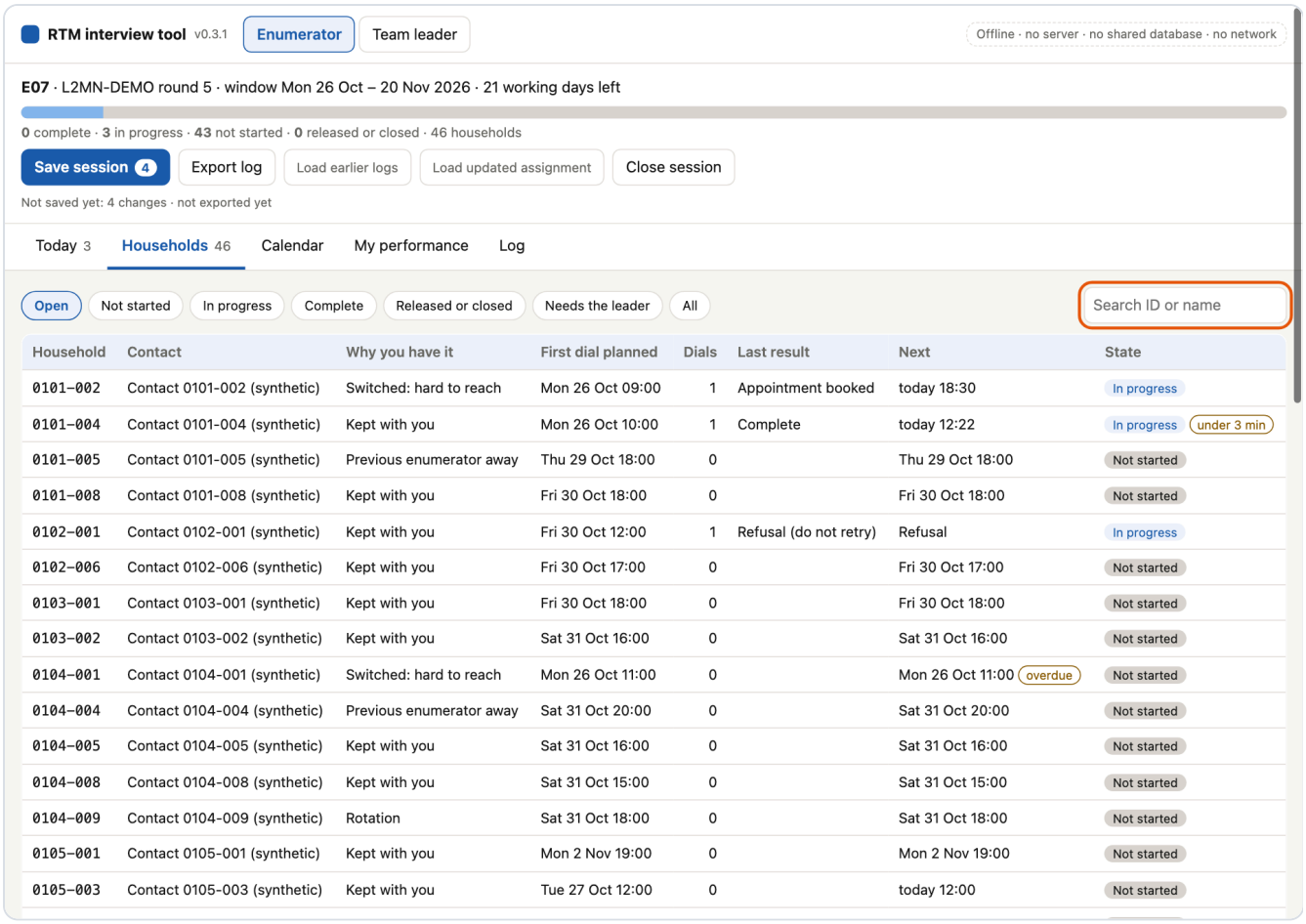


Figure A21. The Households tab, with its filters and the search box.

A15 The Calendar tab

The Calendar shows the round's window month by month. Days inside the window are white; days outside are grey. Hatched days get no calls planned automatically: days the call center does not work, and public holidays. Each day shows the first dials planned, callbacks booked, and the dials made and completes. Click a day to see its calls.

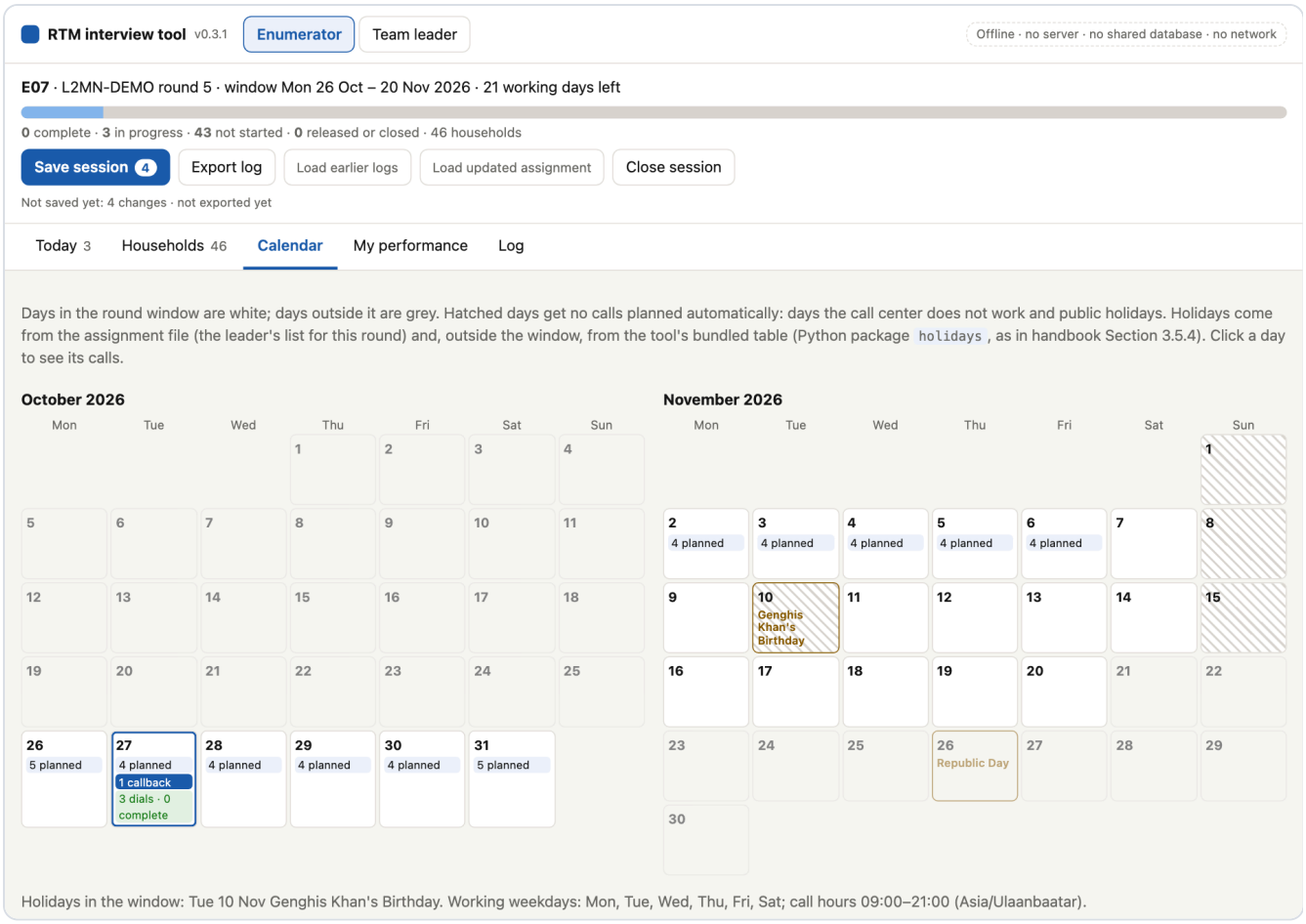


Figure A22. The Calendar tab. 10 November, a public holiday, is hatched.

> Holidays are left out of the automatic plan but never block calling: you can still call and log on a holiday. Your leader can mark a holiday as a working day.

A16 My performance

My performance gives your own figures, with the definitions of Box 3.0: dials, completes, success rate, dials per complete, first-dial success, enumerator-days and completes per enumerator-day. The columns compare this round so far with this month, last month and all the logs loaded. Click **Load earlier logs** and choose your exports from earlier rounds to fill the comparison.

When my calls succeed shows, by hour, the share of your dials on which the interview took place. Hours with fewer than 10 dials are hatched: too few to judge. **The plan ahead** counts the first dials, redials and callbacks for the coming days.

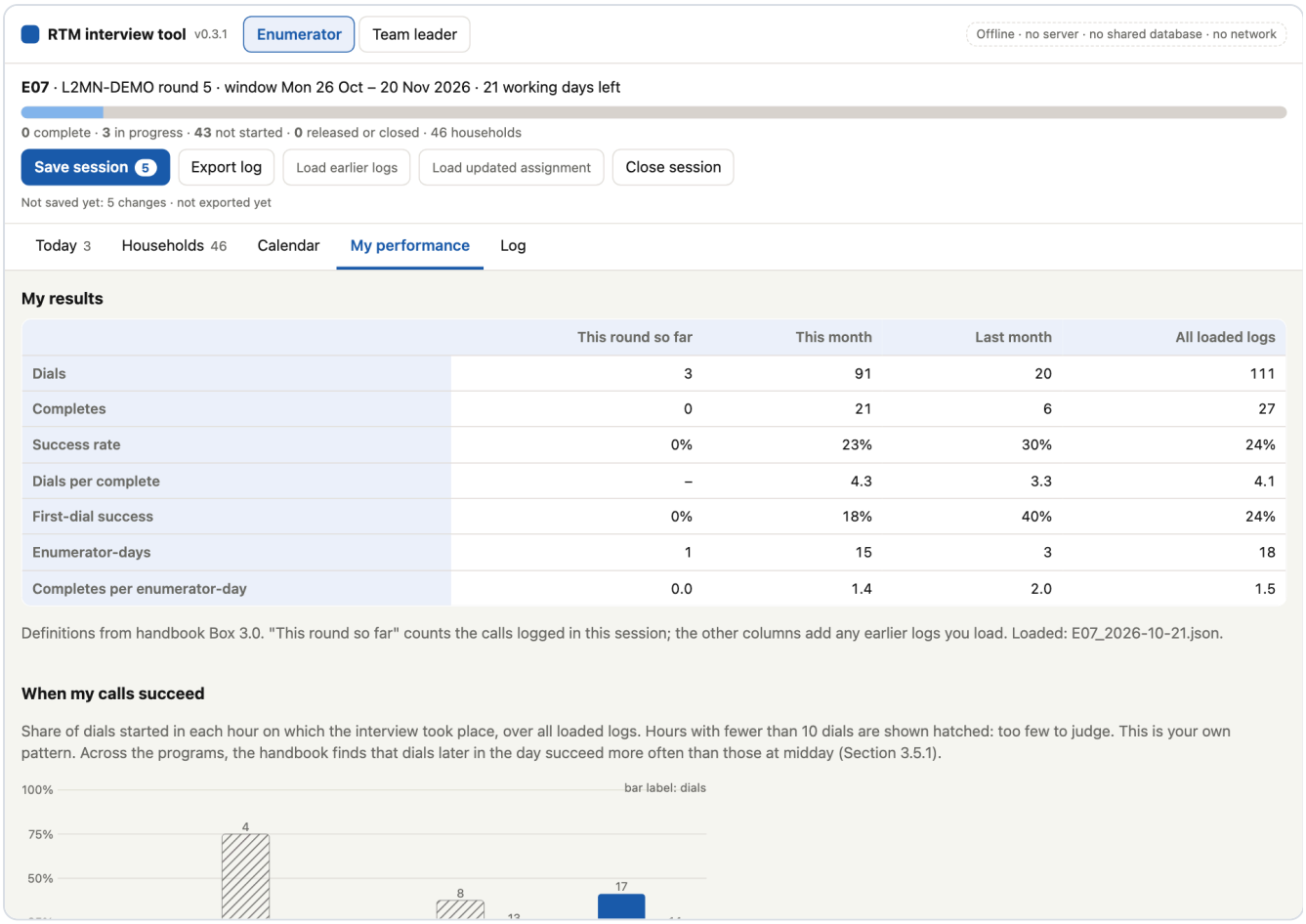


Figure A23. My performance, with an earlier round's log loaded.

A17 The Log tab

The Log lists every entry in your session: each call, action, correction and number change, who logged it and when. Its integrity check confirms that no entry was changed after it was logged. You cannot edit the log here; corrections are new entries (A10).

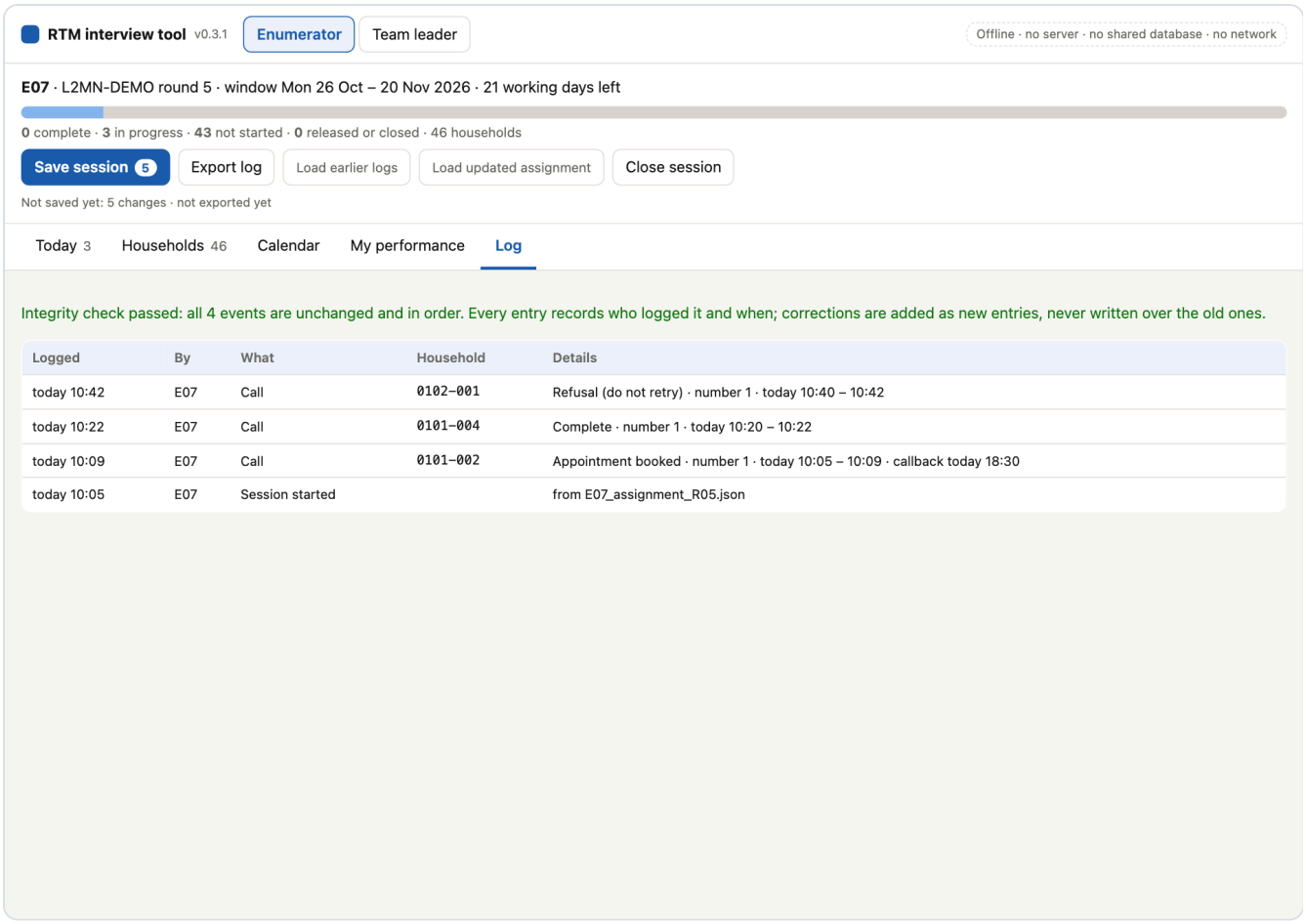


Figure A24. The Log tab and its integrity check.

A18 Save, close and continue

Save your session whenever you stop, and at least every few calls. Click **Save session**:

- In Chrome, the first save asks where to put the file, named like `E07_project_R05.json`, in your own folder; later saves overwrite it.
- In other browsers, each save downloads a new file with the time in its name.

Keep saved sessions in your own folder, not the common one. If your session file is protected, it is protected with your assignment's passphrase. After ten unsaved changes, a reminder appears.

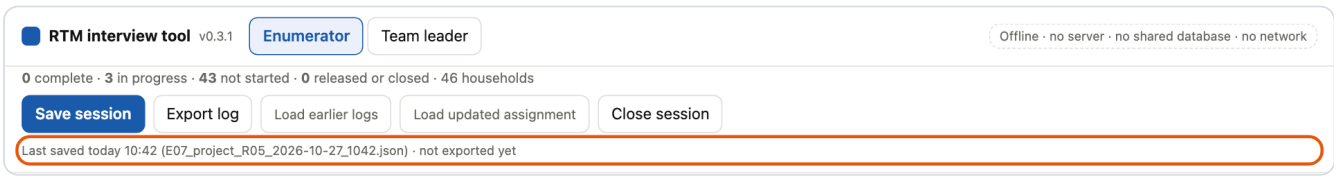


Figure A25. After saving, the line under the buttons gives the time and the file.

Close session asks first when changes are not saved: **Save, then close** (the main choice), **Close without saving**, or **Cancel**. The browser also warns you before you close the page with unsaved changes.

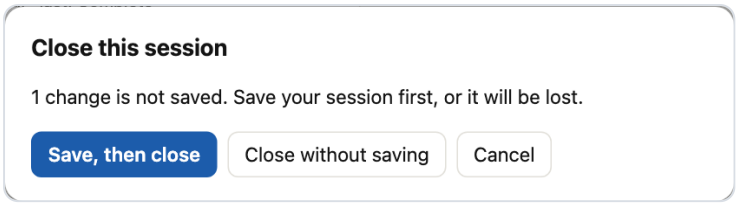


Figure A26. Closing with an unsaved change.

To continue later, open the tool, click **Continue a saved session** on the start page (Figure A1) and choose your saved session file. Everything comes back, and the tool checks that the file was not changed.

A19 Export your log

At the end of each day, and at the end of the round, click **Export log**:

1. Download both files, named like `E07_2026-10-27.csv` and `E07_2026-10-27.json`.
2. Put both in the common folder. They hold household IDs, times and results, but no names or phone numbers.
3. If you added or corrected a number, a third file, `E07_2026-10-27_contacts.json`, is offered. Give it to your leader directly, never in the common folder.

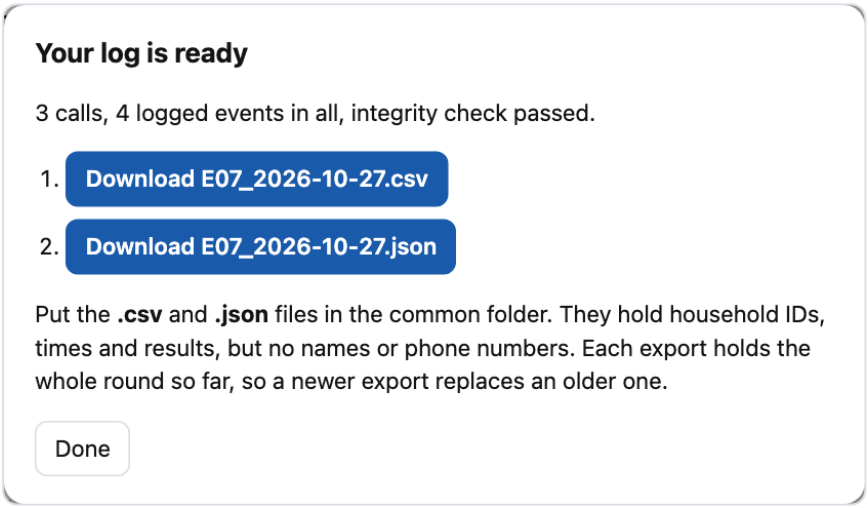


Figure A27. The export window.

> Each export holds the whole round so far, so a newer export replaces an older one. Exporting does not replace saving: save your session as well.

A20 An updated assignment

Your leader may send a new version of your assignment during the round, for example after moving households between enumerators so that the round finishes on time. Click **Load updated assignment** and choose the new file. The tool keeps every call you logged, adds the new households, and marks those no longer yours as “No longer yours”: their calls stay in your log, but you cannot log new ones for them. A file for another enumerator or another round is refused, and so is a file older than the one in your session.

A household moved to you shows who had it before and the calls they made, with the reason “Moved to you mid-round”. Those calls count toward the dial cap: if the previous enumerator made 7 of 8, you have

one left. Its first dial is planned for the day of the move, at the household's usual hour. Households you already had keep their plan and history even when the new file does not repeat them.

A21 On a phone

The page also works on a phone's browser. The columns stack, and a household's panel fills the screen; close it with the ✕ to return to the list.

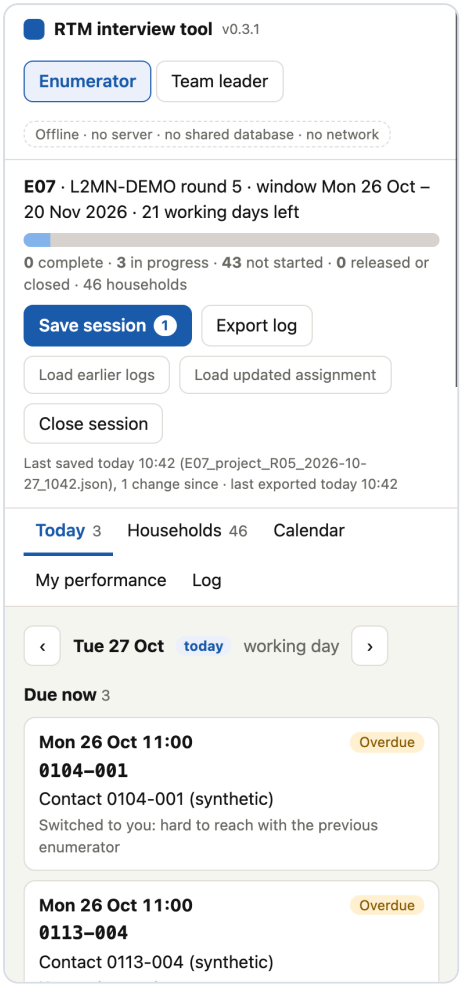


Figure A28. Today, on a phone.

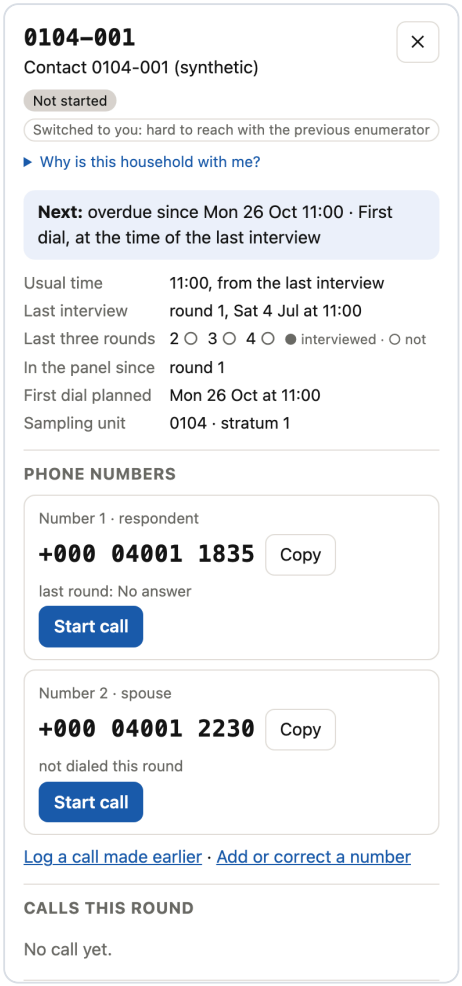


Figure A29. A household, on a phone.

A22 Good practice and messages

- Start the timer when you dial and end it when the call ends: the times are part of the data.
- Save whenever you stop; export at the end of each day.
- Never write personal details in notes. Keep your assignment and saved sessions in your own folder.
- Use a release, not a refusal code, to stop calling a household for the round.

Message	What to do
“Choose the result of the call.” or another missing entry	Fill in the outlined field, then save again
“This complete lasted under 3 minutes…”	Call again, or correct the time if it is wrong (A8, A10)

“N changes are not saved yet.”	Click Save session
A file is protected	Type the passphrase from your leader; it is not stored
“… is a saved session, not an assignment.”	Use Continue a saved session instead
A file for another enumerator or round is refused	Check with your leader that you have your own file

Part B · Team leader

Preparing a round, giving out files, importing exports, following progress

B1 Start or continue a session

Click **Team leader** at the top of the page. To prepare a new round, fill in **Start a round**:

1. your leader ID, for example `L01`, and the program code, for example `L2MN`;
2. the country, which picks the holiday calendar;
3. the round number. Click **Start**.

To carry on, click **Continue a saved leader session** and choose your session file (B11). If you only want to import logs for a round you prepared earlier, start the round the same way and open its manifest on the Import tab (B12).

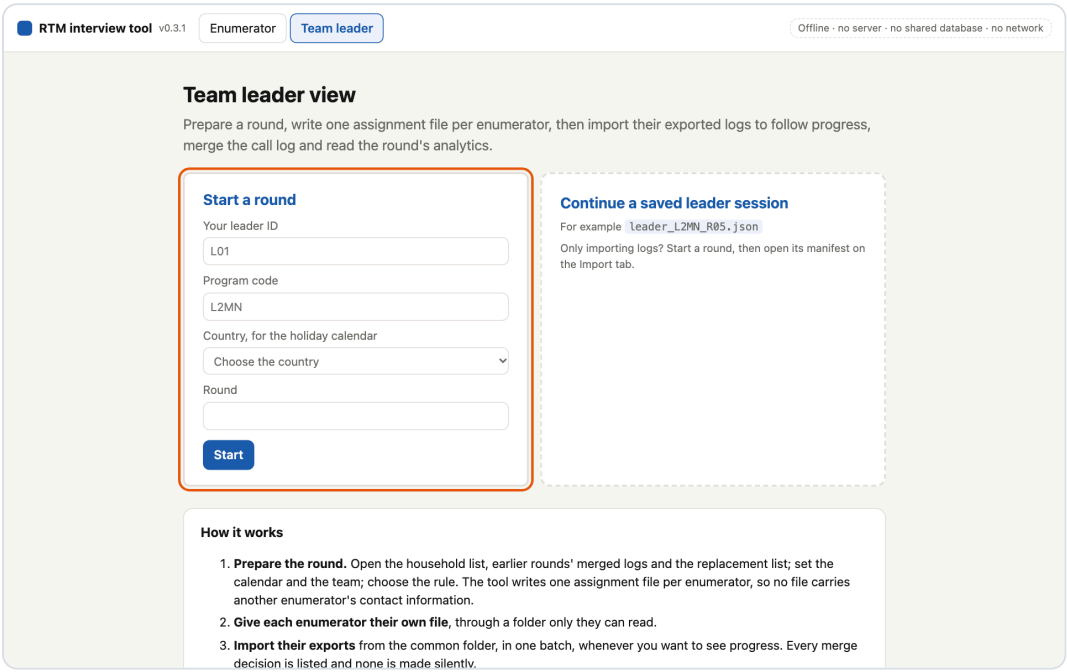


Figure B1. The leader's start page.

B2 The Prepare tab

The session opens on **Prepare round**, eight numbered steps from top to bottom. The other tabs are **Import logs**, **Progress**, **Call log**, **Analytics** and **Risk lists**. The number on **Save leader session** counts the changes not yet saved.

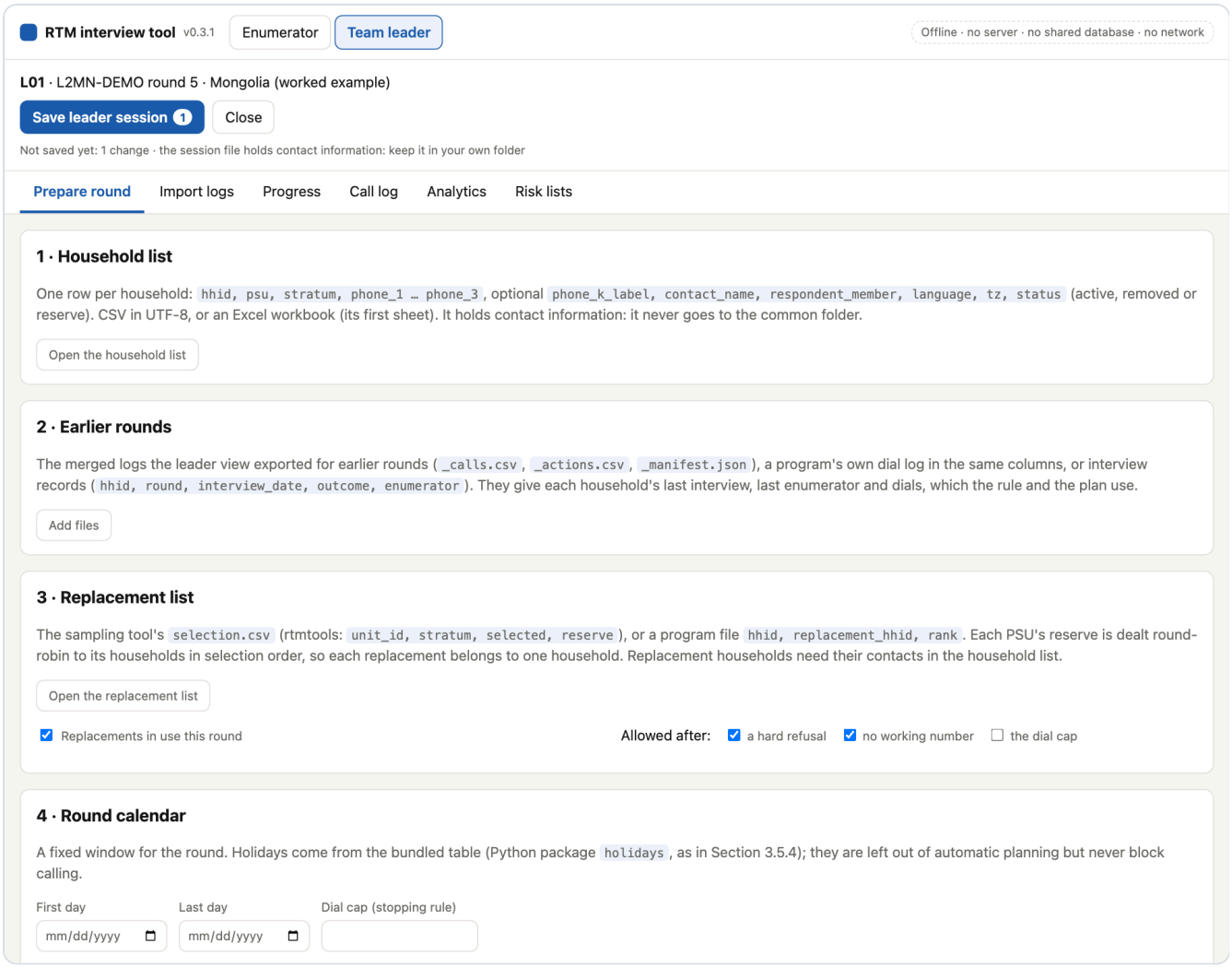


Figure B2. The Prepare tab before any file is opened.

B3 Step 1 · Household list

Click **Open the household list** and choose the program's list: a CSV file in UTF-8, or an Excel workbook (its first sheet). One row per household, with these columns:

Column	Content
`hhid` , `psu` , `stratum`	The household's ID, its sampling unit and stratum
`phone_1` … `phone_3`	Up to three numbers; `phone_k_label` says whose each is
`contact_name` , `respondent_member` , `language` , `tz`	Optional
`status`	`active` (the default), `removed` (kept in the list, never deleted) or `reserve` (a replacement not yet used)

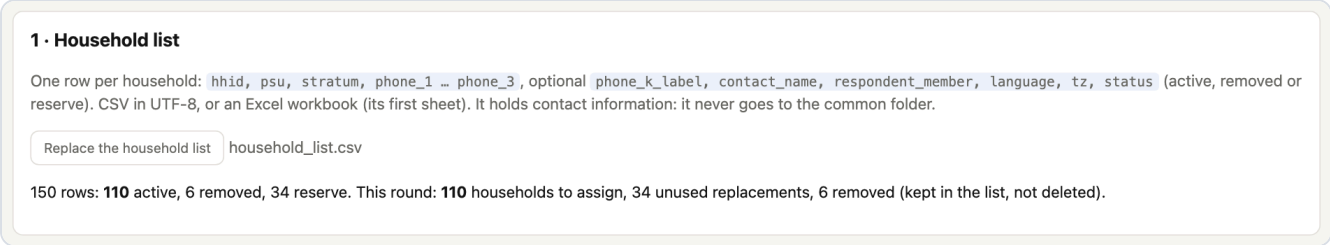


Figure B3. The household list, read: 110 households to assign this round.

> The household list holds contact information. Keep it in your own folder; it never goes in the common folder.

B4 Step 2 · Earlier rounds

Click **Add files** and choose the files of earlier rounds, all at once:

- the merged files this tool wrote for earlier rounds (`_calls.csv` , `_actions.csv` and `_manifest.json`); or
- a program's own dial log in the same columns; or
- interview records with `hhid, round, interview_date, outcome, enumerator` .

They give each household's last interview, last enumerator and dials, which the rule and the plan use. The table shows, for each round, the households, dials and interviewed households. If a program's own result codes are not the tool's, the tool asks you to map each one once.

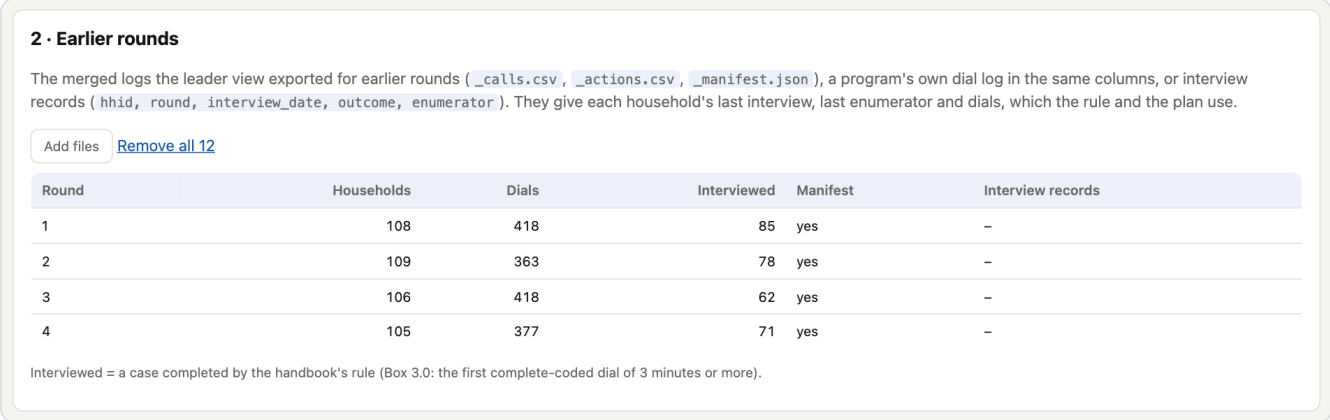


Figure B4. Four earlier rounds, read. Interviewed means a case completed by Box 3.0's rule.

B5 Step 3 · Replacement list

Click **Open the replacement list** and choose either the sampling tool's `selection.csv` (rtmtools: `unit_id, stratum, selected, reserve`) or a program file with `hhid, replacement_hhid, rank` . Each PSU's reserve is dealt in turn to its households in selection order, so each replacement belongs to one household. Replacement households need their contacts in the household list.

Under the summary, tick **Replacements in use this round** and choose when they are **allowed**: after a hard refusal, when no number works, or when the dial cap is reached.

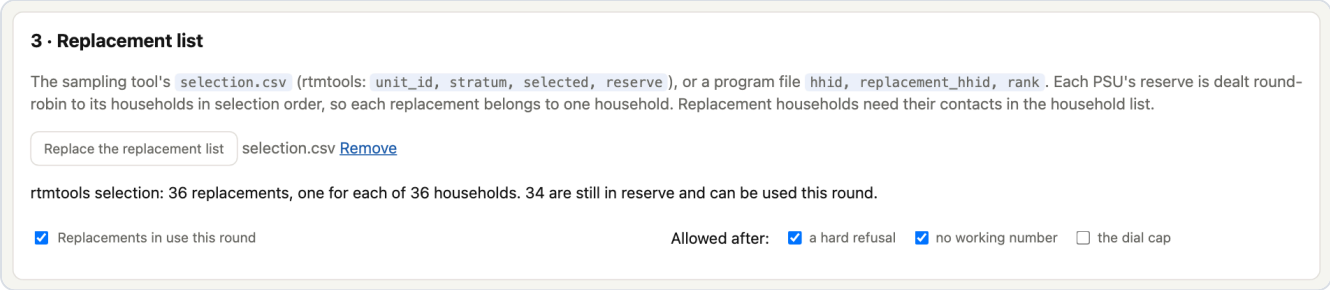


Figure B5. An rtmtools selection, read: one replacement for each of 36 households.

B6 Step 4 · Round calendar

1. Set the round's **first day** and **last day** (a fixed window) and the **dial cap**, the program's stopping rule in dials. The team, dial cap and call hours are taken from the last round's manifest when one is loaded.
2. Tick the **working days** and set the **call hours** and the **time zone**.
3. Choose over what share of the working days the first dials are spread (50% by default), to front-load the contact effort (Section 3.4).
4. Set the **day list**: how many households each enumerator's Today tab offers at most each day. It is taken from the last round's manifest when one is loaded; empty, it becomes 1.5 × the busiest enumerator's planned first dials per day, shown once the rule is applied (step 6). The enumerator sees the calls due first, then households pulled forward from later days (“Ahead of plan”, A3), so that unanswered calls leave nobody waiting.
5. Check the **holidays inside the window**. They come from a table bundled with the tool, built from the Python package `holidays`. Tick **Call center works** for a holiday you will work, **remove** a day that is not a holiday, or **add a day off**, such as a regional or decreed closure. Dates the table estimates, such as lunar holidays, are labelled; correct them when the official dates are known.

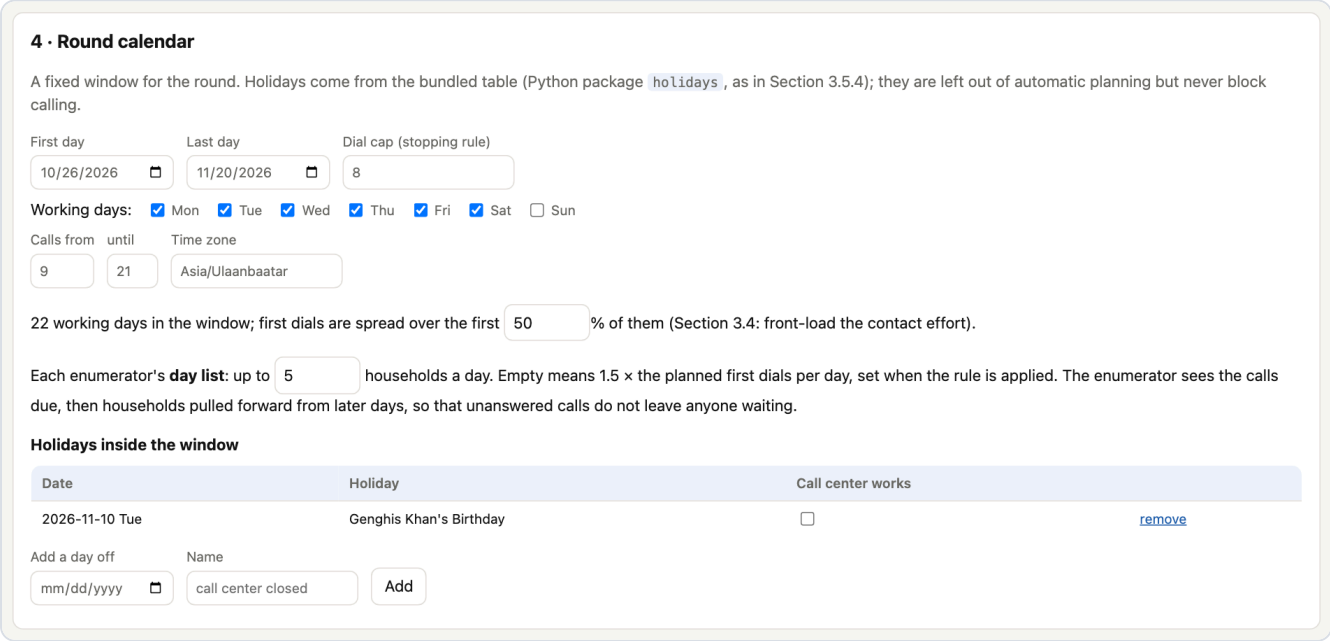


Figure B6. The round calendar: 22 working days, with the 10 November holiday.

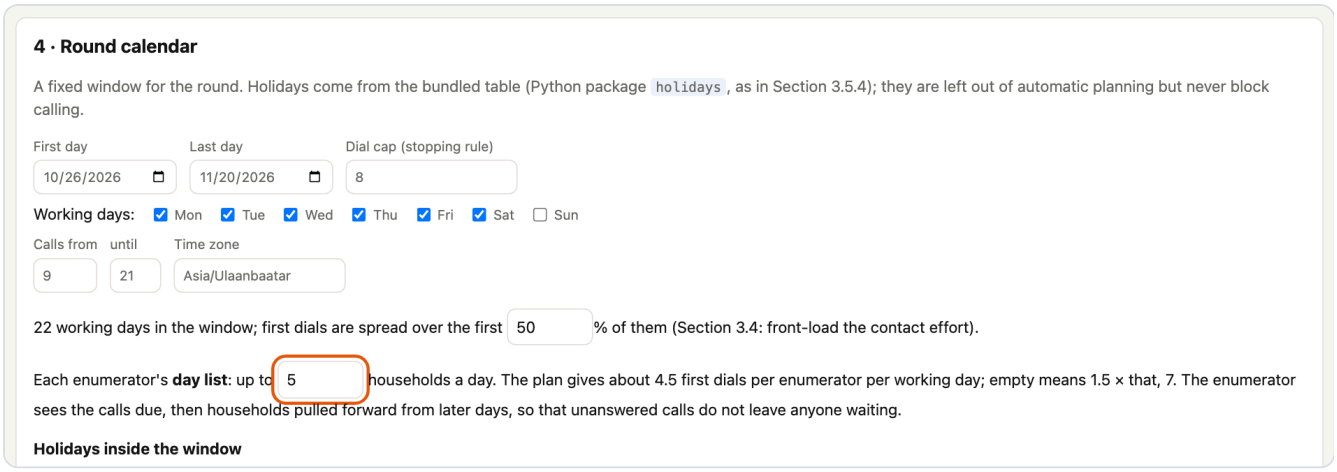


Figure B6b. The day list after the rule is applied: the plan's first dials per enumerator per day, and the default of 1.5 × that.

When the window falls in Ramadan, the card also asks for the hour the fast is broken; that hour is kept free of planned calls.

B7 Step 5 · Team

The team comes from the last round's manifest, or is added with **Add an enumerator ID**. For each enumerator:

- untick **Available this round** for someone who is away. They keep their history; their households are dealt to the others with the reason “enumerator unavailable”;
- set a **share**: relative weights (1 each by default), or percentages adding up to 100 under the “share of total” rule;
- **remove** someone who has left.

Matching criteria. Above the table, the card offers the columns of the household list that can decide who calls whom: `language`, and any other column with few distinct values, such as the respondent's sex, a dialect or an area (add the column to the household list; nothing else changes). Tick a criterion and a column appears in the team table: type each enumerator's values, several separated by spaces or commas (`mn kk`). A household then goes only to an enumerator whose values include the household's; a household without a value can go to anyone. Every available enumerator needs a value for every criterion ticked. The criteria and the values are written into the manifest and the assignment files, so the program can say how it assigned, and the next round offers them again.

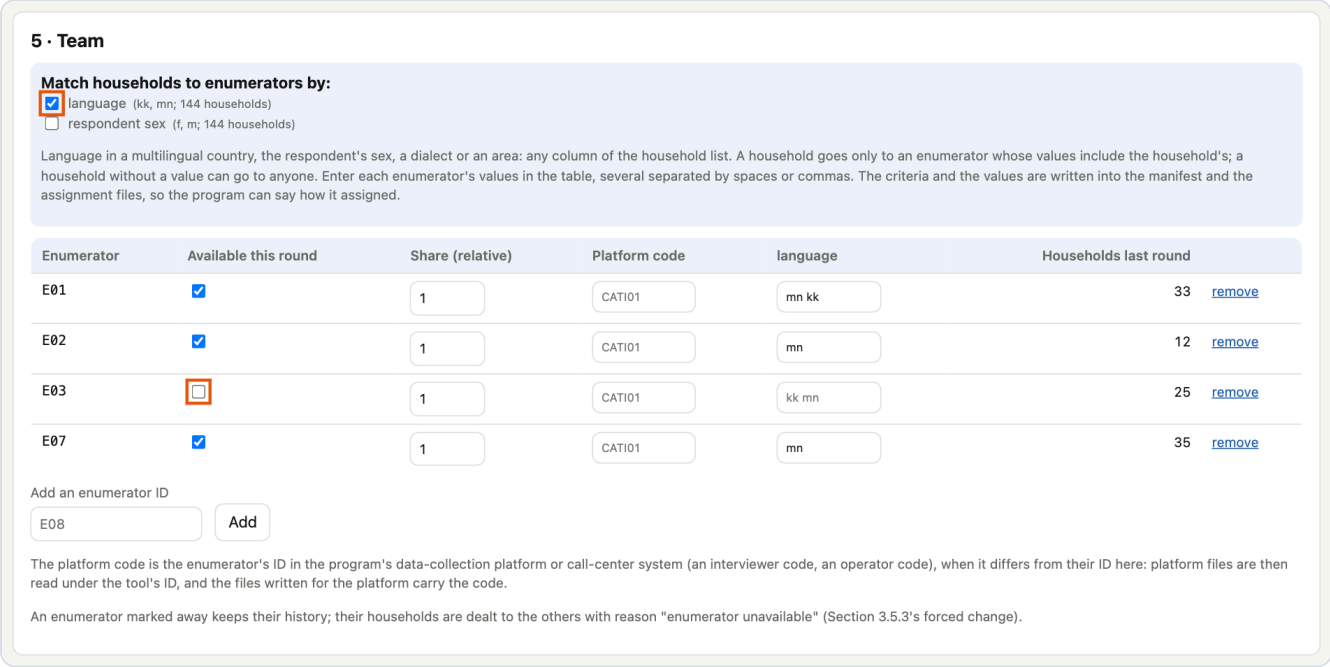


Figure B7. The team, with E03 marked away this round, and the language criterion: E01 speaks Mongolian and Kazakh, the others Mongolian.

B8 Step 6 · Assignment rule

Rule	What it does	When to use it
Keep the same enumerator (default)	Each household stays with the enumerator who completed its last interview. A planned share rotates to another enumerator each round, and a hard-to-reach household is switched. New households are dealt at random	Every round after the first: the handbook's stated default (Section 3.5.3)
Random	Households dealt at random, mixing strata, in proportion to the shares	The first round, or a round where enumerator effects must be estimated
Equal split	Consecutive blocks of the list in a chosen order (PSU, stratum, language or ID), sizes differing by at most one	When enumerators must match a language or an area. Enumerator and area effects then cannot be told apart
Share of total	Like equal split or random, with shares that add up to 100%	Part-time or new enumerators
Manual	A list of `hhid` and `enumerator_id` that you open; households without one, and unknown IDs, are flagged	Special cases

Under the default rule, enter the **rotation share** for this round, for example 10%. It has no default: the handbook calls its size “a judgment, not an estimate from these data”. A household is **hard to reach** when it was not interviewed last round although it received the full dial cap, or when its enumerator asked for a switch.

The **seed** is written into every file, so the same inputs and seed always give the same assignment. Click **Apply the rule**. If something is missing, such as the window or the rotation share, the tool lists it above the button.

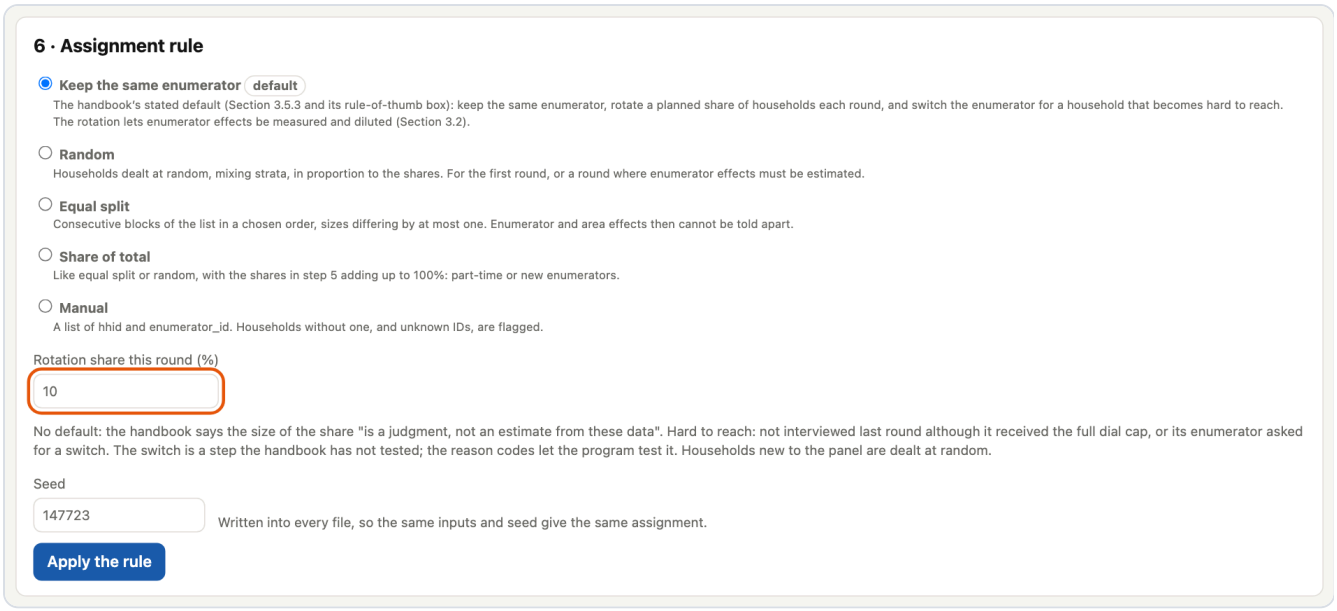


Figure B8. The rules, with the rotation share entered.

> If you change a setting after applying the rule (the team, the seed, the share, the window, the working days or the holidays), the tool sets the assignment and any files written from it aside and asks you to apply the rule again. Files and assignment always match the settings shown.

B9 Step 7 · Check the assignment

Before any file is written, step 7 shows each enumerator's households: by reason (kept, rotation, hard to reach, enumerator away, new, or by the round's rule), by stratum, and in total. It also shows the **expected dials**, computed from each household's dials last round, against the enumerator's target share.

- Loads outside the **margin** (15% by default) are marked. **Move kept households at random to balance** moves kept households from the busiest to the least busy enumerators, with the reason “capacity”, until every load is within the margin.
- Open **Households: move one by hand** to change any household's enumerator; the move is recorded as “by hand”.
- With matching criteria (B7), a kept household whose enumerator does not match moves with the reason “matched”, the balance never moves a household to an enumerator who does not match it, and the card says whether every household is with a matching enumerator. A household that no available enumerator matches is listed at the top of the household table without an enumerator: choose one by hand (it is marked as not matched), or give an enumerator the value in step 5. No file is written while a household has no enumerator.

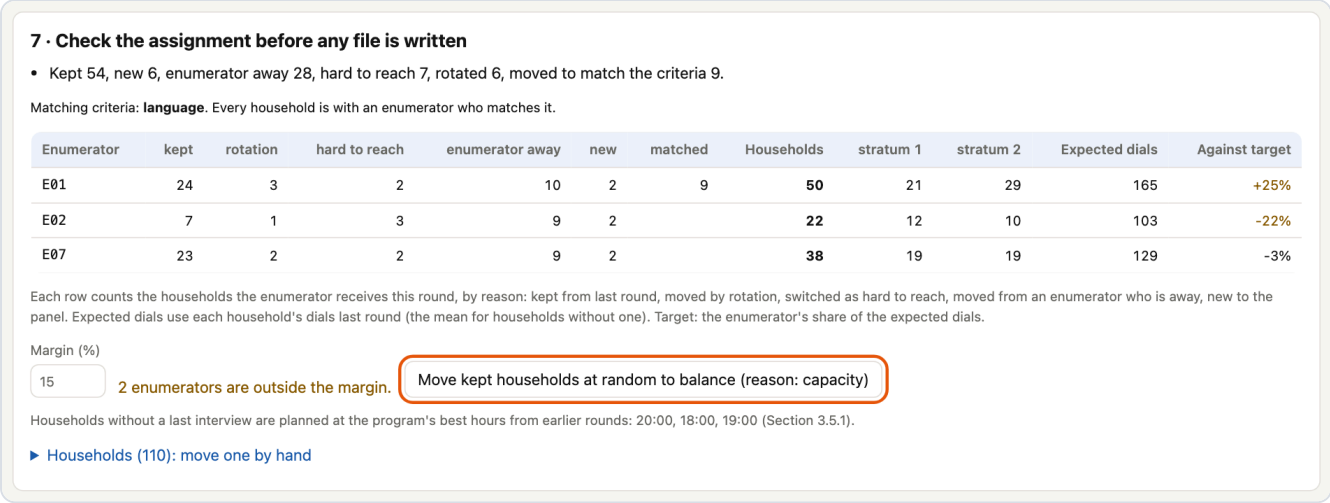


Figure B9. The check, with the language criterion: the households moved to match are counted under “matched”.

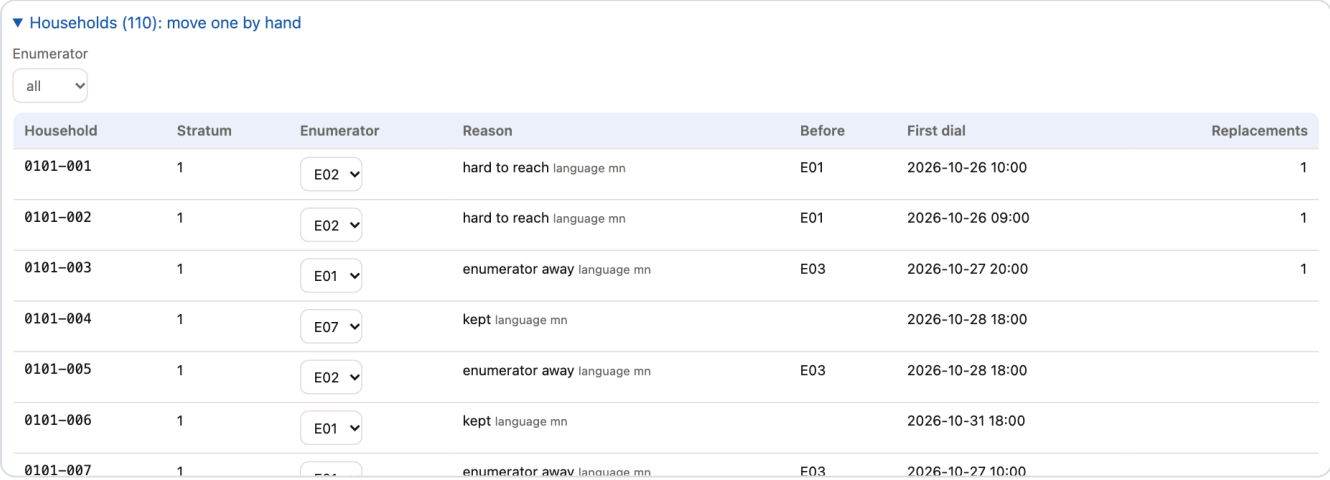


Figure B10. Moving one household by hand.

Households without a last interview are planned at the program's best hours from earlier rounds (Section 3.5.1). New households, households switched as hard to reach and households in the high dropout tier (B18) get the earliest first dials.

B10 Step 8 · Write and give out the files

1. Tick **Protect each assignment file with its own passphrase** if a file could end up in the wrong place. The tool makes one passphrase per enumerator and shows them once: copy them or click **Download the passphrase list**. They are not saved anywhere.
2. Click **Write the files**. If some loads are still outside the margin, a reminder names them; you can still write.
3. Click **Save all into a folder** (Chrome) or **Download all**.

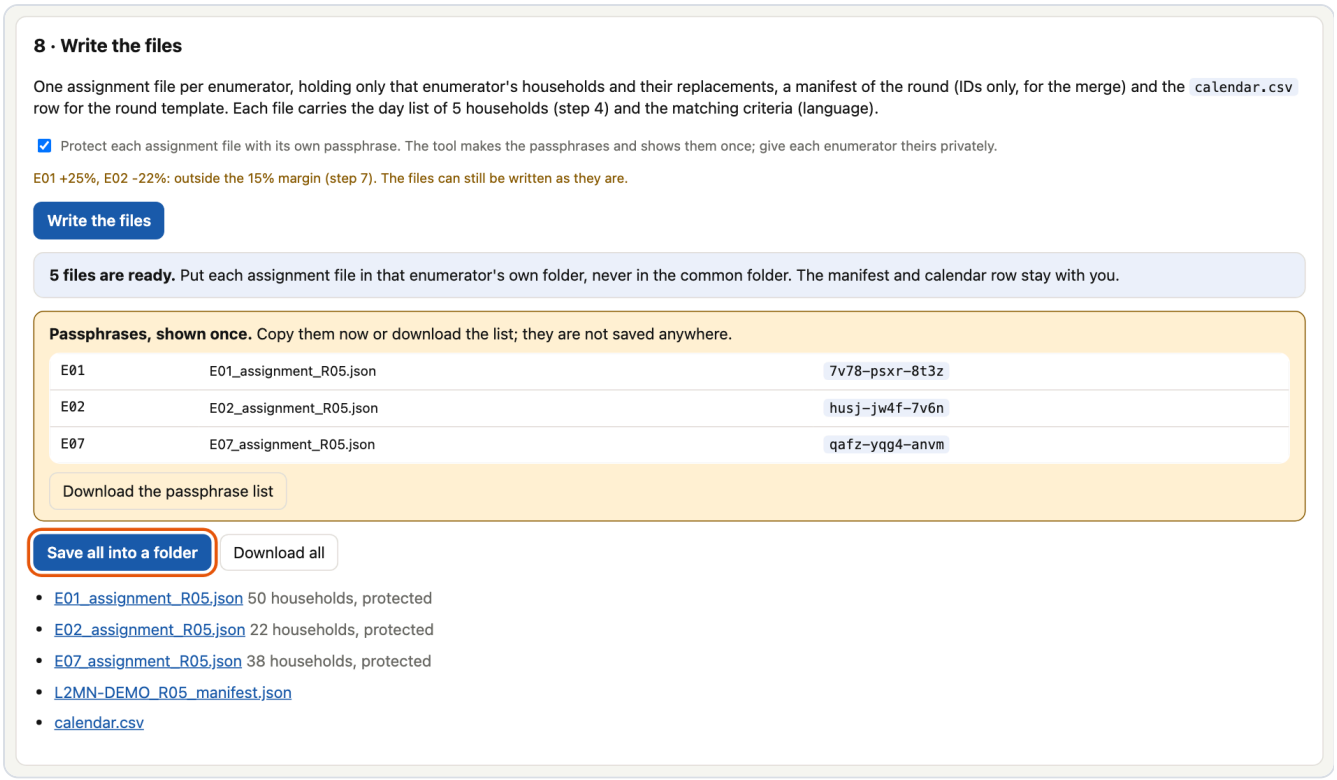


Figure B11. Five files ready, with the passphrases shown once.

File	Where it goes
`E01_assignment_R05.json`, one per enumerator	Into that enumerator's own folder, never the common folder. Give the passphrase separately, privately
`L2MN-DEMO_R05_manifest.json`	Stays with you: the merge checks every export against it (IDs only)
`calendar.csv`	The round's row for the handbook's round template

> Each assignment file holds only its enumerator's households and their replacements, with their contacts. No file carries another enumerator's contact information.

B11 Save and close the session

Click **Save leader session** to keep the inputs, settings, imports and every decision in one file, `leader_L2MN-DEMO_R05.json`. To protect it, type a passphrase twice; leave both empty to save it unprotected. The file holds the household list with its contacts: keep it in your own folder.

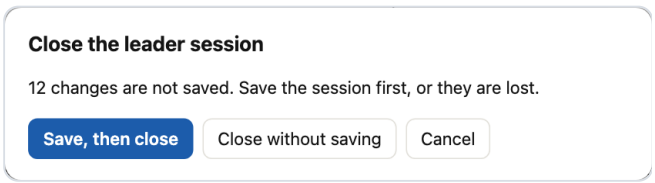


Figure B13. Closing with unsaved changes.

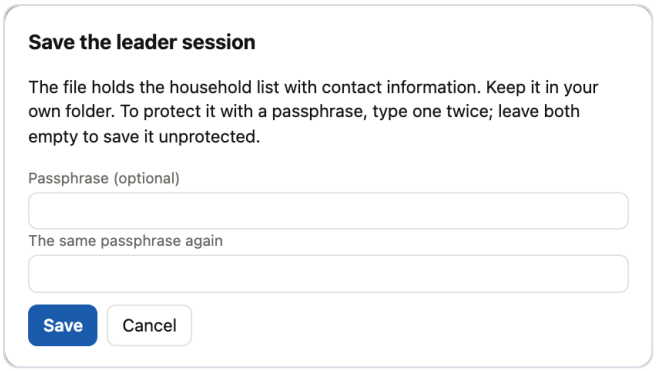


Figure B12. Saving the leader session.

B12 Import the exports

Whenever you want to see progress, open the **Import logs** tab.

1. If the session has no manifest yet (for example a new session for importing only), click **Open a round manifest** and choose the manifest written in step 8.
2. Click **Add files** and choose the enumerators' exports from the common folder, all at once: their `.json` and `.csv` files, and any contacts files they gave you. Adding older exports does no harm: the newest export of each enumerator is used.



Figure B14. A session without a manifest asks for one.

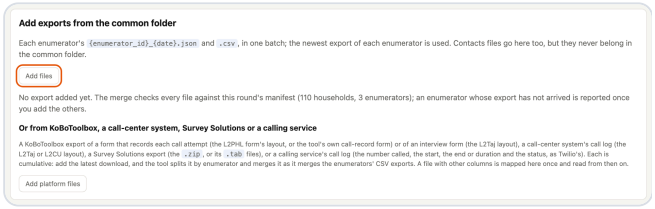


Figure B15. Adding the exports.

B13 Merge questions and the merge report

The merge never decides silently. Each situation it finds is a line in the merge report; those that need you appear under **Needs your decision**, with a button for each choice and an optional note. A decision is logged with who took it and when, and can be reviewed in the report.

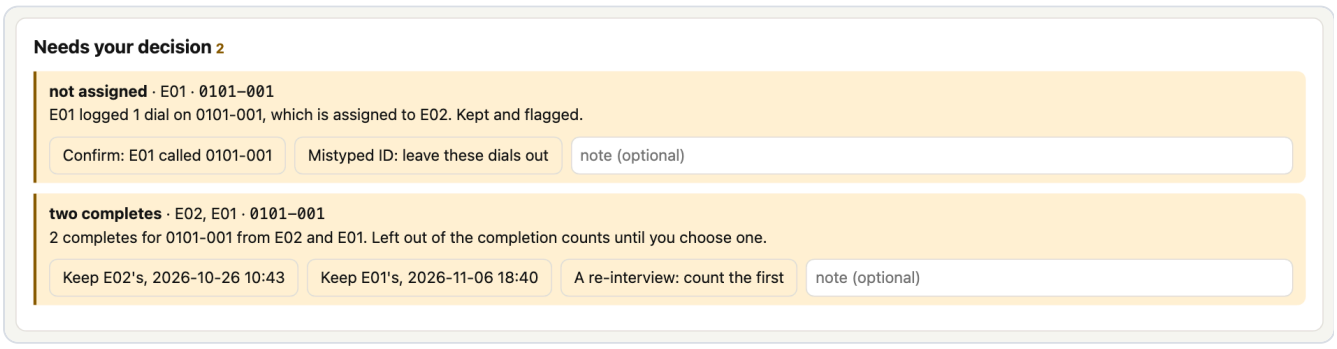
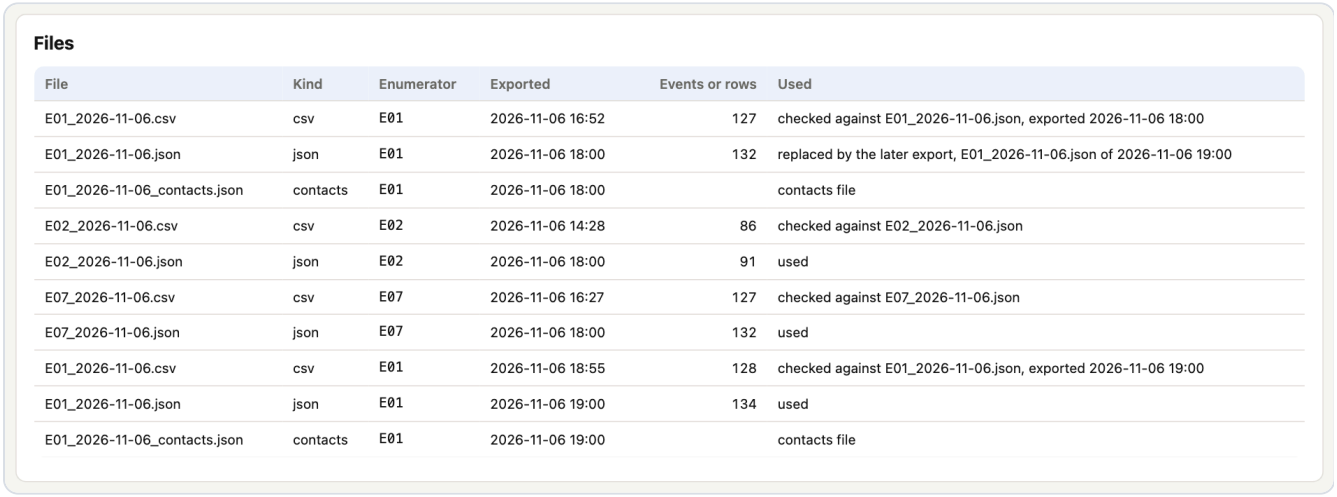


Figure B16. Two questions: dials on a household assigned to someone else, and two completes for one household.

Situation	What the tool does	What you decide

No export from an enumerator	Their households show as “not reported”, apart from completes and misses	Ask for the export
The same file added twice	The copy is ignored and noted	Nothing
Two exports from one enumerator	The later export is used; the earlier is noted. Dials the later one lacks are kept and flagged	For a gap: keep the dials, or leave them out if they were voided
Dials on a household assigned to someone else	Kept and flagged	Confirm the call, or mark a mistyped ID
Two completes for one household	Both kept, left out of the completion counts	Keep one, or count a re-interview
A file changed after export	Its integrity check fails; a differing entry is left out of the counts	Choose which version to use
A file from another round or program	Not merged	Open it in that round's session
A CSV without its JSON	Used as unverified when it is the latest export	Ask for the JSON when possible
Times that cannot be right	Flagged, kept	Check the enumerator's computer clock

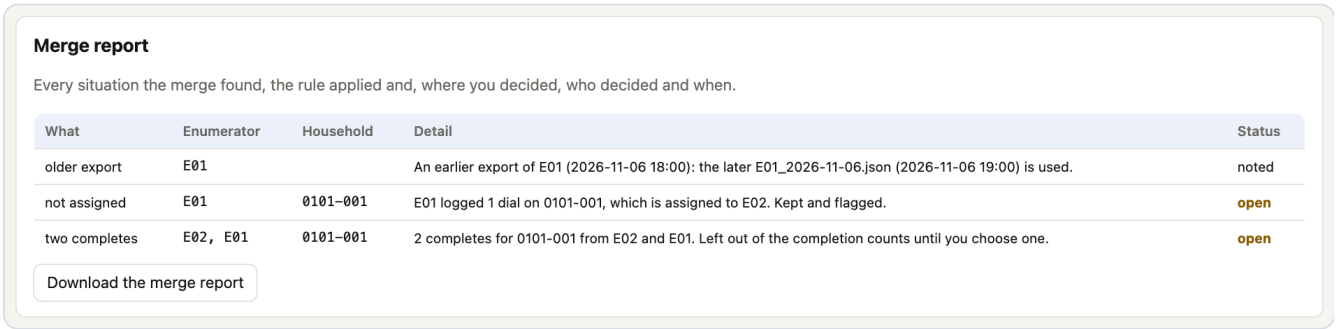
The **Files** table shows how each file was used. **Download the merge report** keeps the record of every situation, the rule applied and your decisions.



Files

File	Kind	Enumerator	Exported	Events or rows	Used
E01_2026-11-06.csv	csv	E01	2026-11-06 16:52	127	checked against E01_2026-11-06.json, exported 2026-11-06 18:00
E01_2026-11-06.json	json	E01	2026-11-06 18:00	132	replaced by the later export, E01_2026-11-06.json of 2026-11-06 19:00
E01_2026-11-06_contacts.json	contacts	E01	2026-11-06 18:00		contacts file
E02_2026-11-06.csv	csv	E02	2026-11-06 14:28	86	checked against E02_2026-11-06.json
E02_2026-11-06.json	json	E02	2026-11-06 18:00	91	used
E07_2026-11-06.csv	csv	E07	2026-11-06 16:27	127	checked against E07_2026-11-06.json
E07_2026-11-06.json	json	E07	2026-11-06 18:00	132	used
E01_2026-11-06.csv	csv	E01	2026-11-06 18:55	128	checked against E01_2026-11-06.json, exported 2026-11-06 19:00
E01_2026-11-06.json	json	E01	2026-11-06 19:00	134	used
E01_2026-11-06_contacts.json	contacts	E01	2026-11-06 19:00		contacts file

Figure B17. The files of a batch and how each was used.



Merge report

Every situation the merge found, the rule applied and, where you decided, who decided and when.

What	Enumerator	Household	Detail	Status
older export	E01		An earlier export of E01 (2026-11-06 18:00): the later E01_2026-11-06.json (2026-11-06 19:00) is used.	noted
not assigned	E01	0101-001	E01 logged 1 dial on 0101-001, which is assigned to E02. Kept and flagged.	open
two completes	E02, E01	0101-001	2 completes for 0101-001 from E02 and E01. Left out of the completion counts until you choose one.	open

Download the merge report

Figure B18. The merge report on screen.

B14 New or corrected numbers

Numbers that enumerators added or corrected arrive in their contacts files. **Download contact updates** gives them in one table; move them into the household list for the next round. The file holds phone numbers: keep it in your own folder.

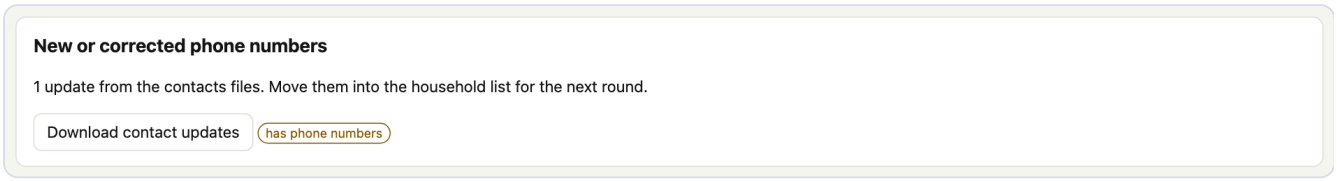


Figure B19. One contact update from the batch.

B15 Progress

The **Progress** tab follows the round:

- **Team:** each enumerator's households by state, dials, enumerator-days, share complete and completes per enumerator-day (Box 3.0), with the time of their last export.
- **Completes over the window:** cumulative completes by day, and completion by stratum.
- **Households:** every household with its enumerator, reason, state, dials and last result, filtered by state or enumerator.

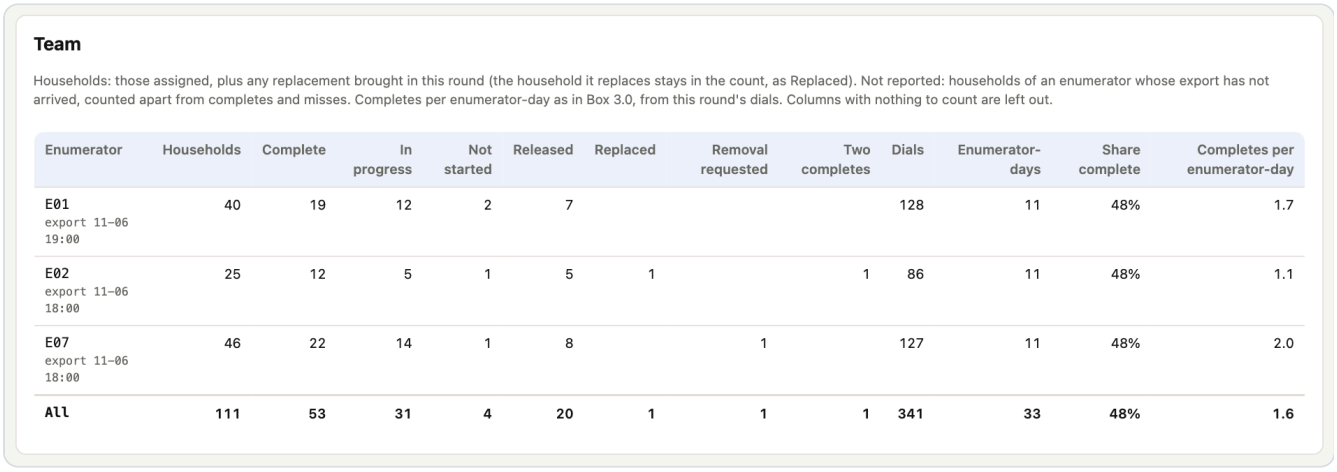


Figure B20. The team's progress.

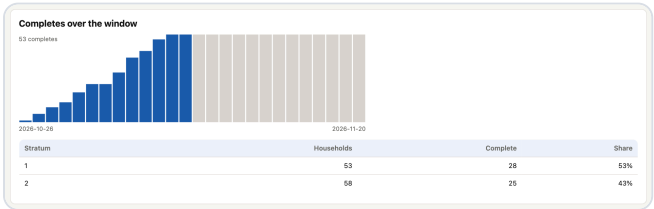


Figure B21. Completes by day and by stratum.

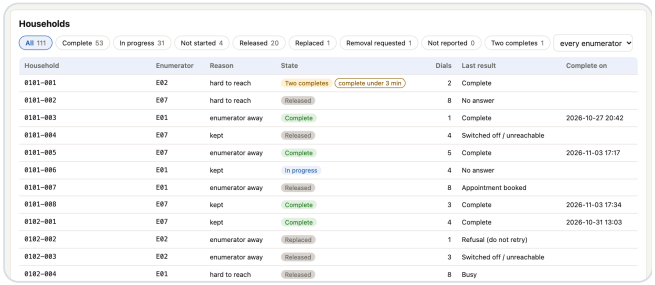


Figure B22. The households, with their state.

Move waiting households

Part-way through the round, the card **Move waiting households** shows, for each enumerator, the completes per enumerator-day so far (the pace), how many they can still complete in the working days left, and whether they are **short** or have **spare** days at that pace. Only enumerators whose latest export is from today, with two or more enumerator-days, are judged; tick the box to judge earlier exports too.

1. Choose which households may move: those not yet called (the default), or also those called without a booked callback or a hard refusal. A complete, a released or replaced household and a replacement never move.
2. Click **Propose moves**. Households move one at a time from the enumerator furthest behind to the one with most spare days, until nobody is more than half a household off; the latest-planned households go first, and only to an enumerator who matches their criteria (B7). Untick a move to leave that household where it is, or add one by hand by its ID.
3. Click **Write the updated files**. The tool writes a new assignment file for each enumerator who gives or receives a household (revision 2, 3…) and the next revision of the manifest, which lists every move with when and by whom. Give each file to its enumerator, who opens it with **Load updated assignment** (A20). This needs the household list open in the session (step 1).

No household is in two files, and no double call goes unnoticed: a moved household carries the dials its previous enumerator made, which count toward the dial cap, and in the merge the previous enumerator's dials up to the move are theirs while any made after it is flagged for you to keep or leave out.

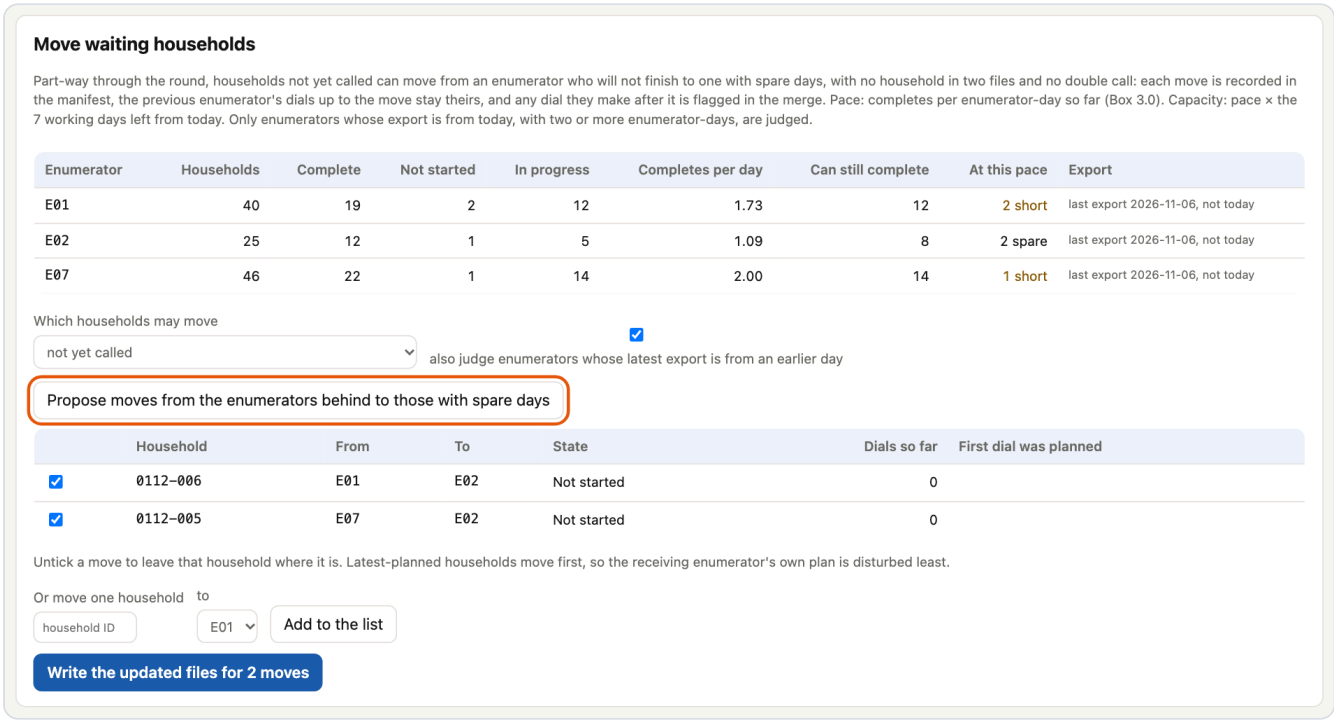


Figure B22b. Who is short and who has spare days, and the moves proposed.

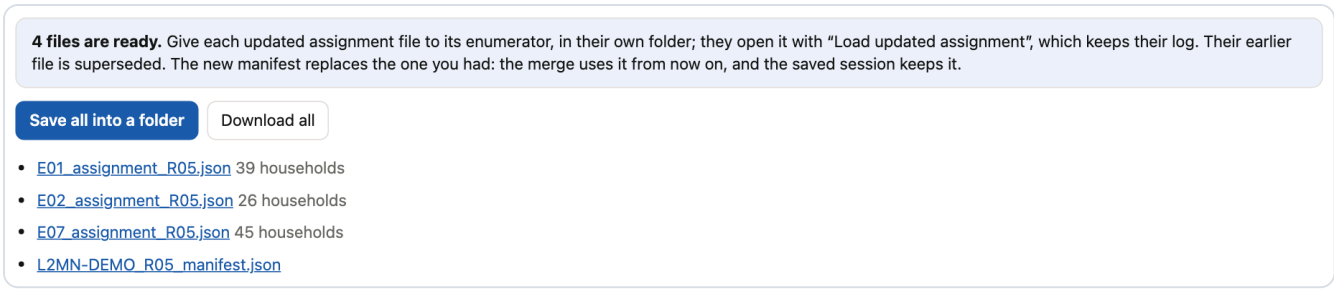


Figure B22c. The revised files and the manifest's next revision, ready to give out.

B16 Call log and the round's files

The **Call log** tab shows the merged call log, filtered by enumerator, result or household, and writes the round's files:

Button	File	Use
Merged call log (CSV)	`L2MN-DEMO_R05_calls.csv`	Every dial, in the handbook's harmonized dial columns; the handbook's analysis scripts and this tool read it as an earlier round
Actions (CSV)	`L2MN-DEMO_R05_actions.csv`	Releases, switch and removal requests, replacements
interviews.csv	`interviews.csv`	One row per household for the handbook's round template (Section 4.2)
outcome_codes.csv	`outcome_codes.csv`	The outcome codes and their meanings, for the template's configuration
calendar.csv	`calendar.csv`	The round's window, for the template
Manifest	`L2MN-DEMO_R05_manifest.json`	The round's assignment, IDs only

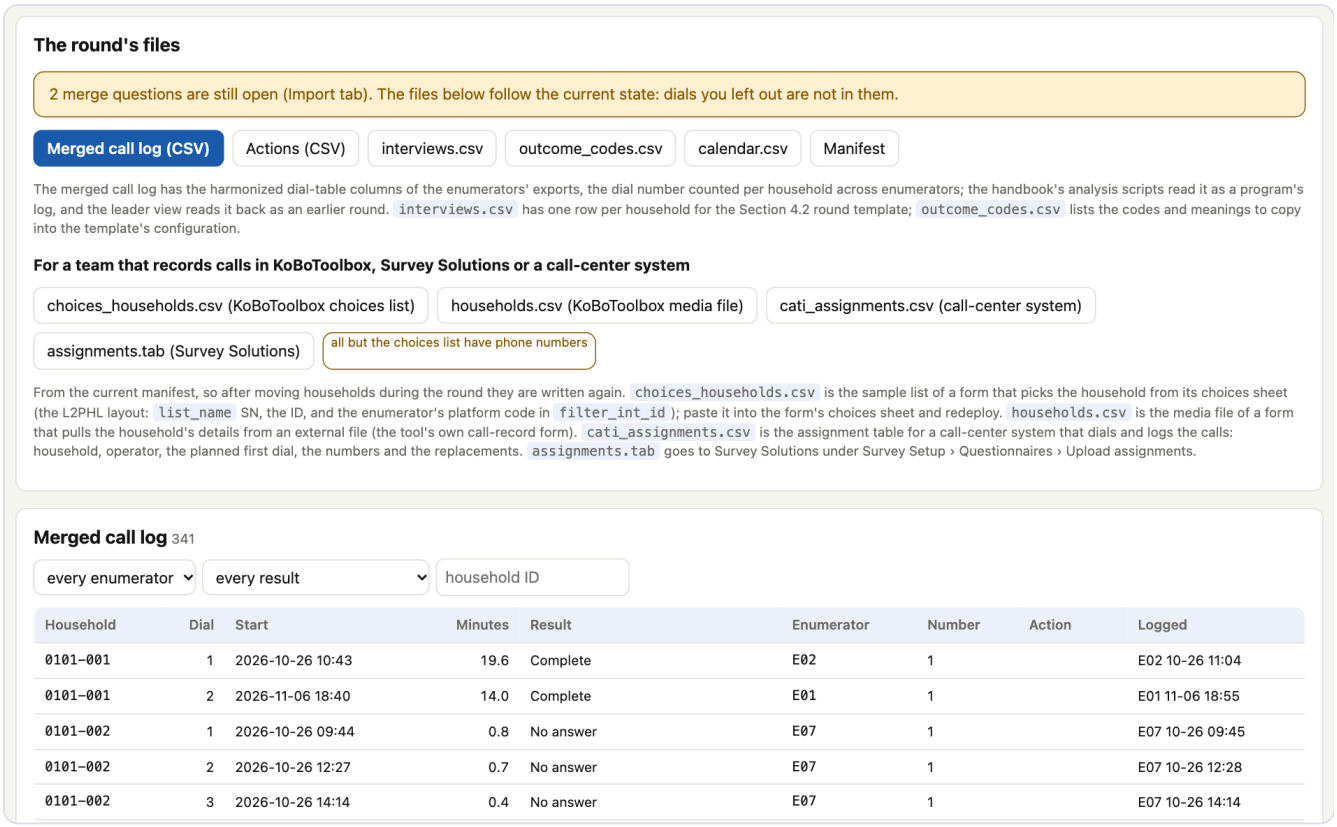


Figure B23. The round's files and the merged call log. While questions are open, the files follow the current state.

B17 Analytics

With earlier rounds loaded (step 2), the **Analytics** tab computes the handbook's measures, with the same definitions as its scripts. All measures are unweighted. The attrition measures use closed rounds only; the round under way appears as “so far”.

Section	Measures
Continuation and retention (Box 2.0, Section 3.4.3)	Continuation round to round, retention of the first-round sample, retention by rounds since joining, cohorts
Loss and returns (Section 3.4.3)	Loss by rounds since joining, returns within three rounds, recruitment waves
Dials per complete (Section 3.3)	Dials per complete, completion, first-dial success, hazard by dial, missed households redialed
Productivity (Section 3.1)	Completes per enumerator-day, dial minutes, attendance, by enumerator
Timing (Section 3.5)	Success by hour, best and busiest hours, weekdays, the first dial against the last interview's time, continuity, holidays, Ramadan

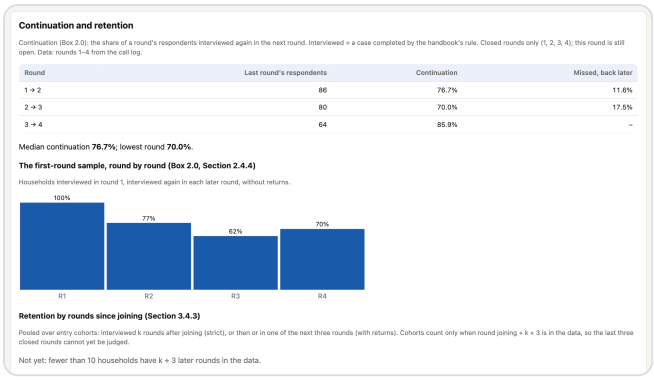


Figure B24. Continuation and retention.

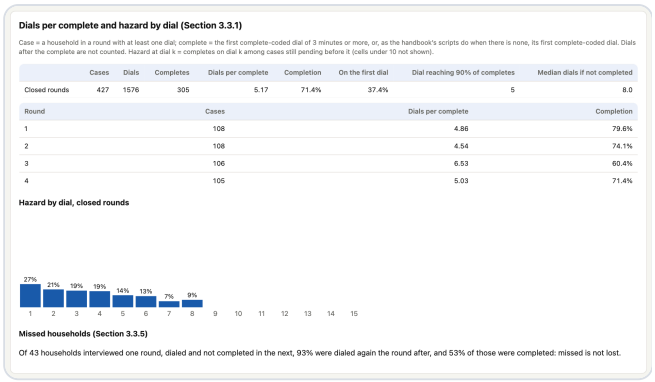


Figure B25. Dials per complete and hazard by dial.

B18 Risk lists

The **Risk lists** tab is for the leader only. Two models rank households to order the work:

- **Dropout risk** ranks last round's respondents by how likely they are to be missed this round. It was trained on the handbook's six programs with dial logs.
- **Return likelihood** ranks the households interviewed two rounds ago and missed last round by how likely they are to come back. It was trained on two programs and is weak: use it only to order redials.

Tiers are tied to workload: within the round, the top 15% by score are high, the next 35% medium and the rest low (the return model has only high and low). A tier says how similar households fared; it is never a prediction about one household and never a reason to drop one (Section 3.3.5). Enumerators never see tiers, and tiers are not written into assignment files; the high dropout tier only gets earlier first dials in the plan. The models use operational features only, never demographic ones.

Each list shows the household, its enumerator, its tier, its score against the round's average, and what moves the score most. Use the tier buttons to filter, and **Download this list** to keep it.

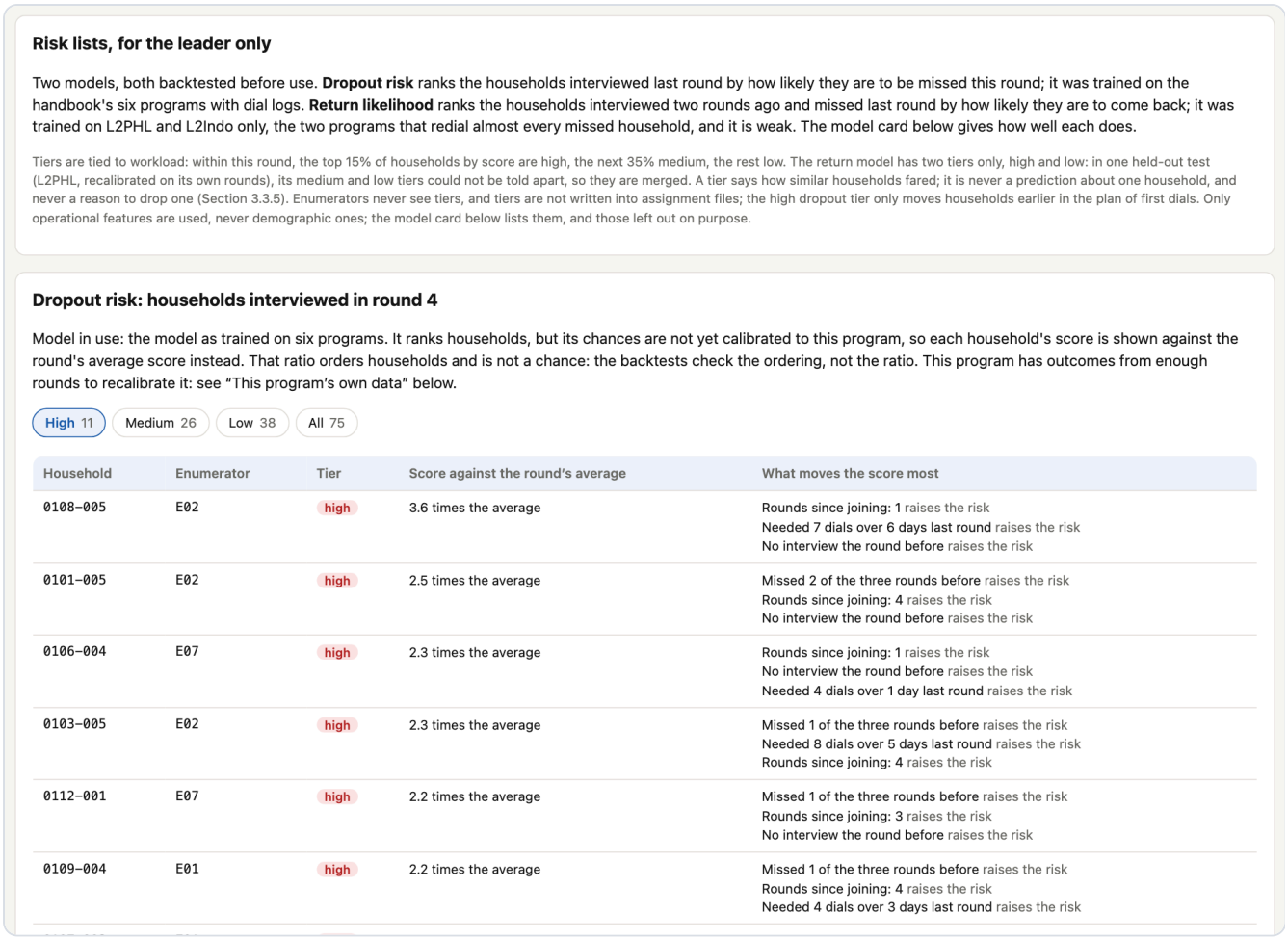


Figure B26. The risk lists: the explanation and the dropout list's high tier.

This program's own data. Applied to a new program, the models rank households usefully but their chances are not calibrated, so the list shows a score, not a chance. Once two rounds have outcomes, click **Backtest on this program's own rounds**. The tool reads the result out in words, from the backtest's 95% interval:

- "too few outcomes to judge": keep the version in use and backtest again after the next round;
- "worse than chance": do not use the lists for this program;
- otherwise it says whether the recalibrated version brings the chances closer to what happened.

Choose **use** on a version only if the backtest supports it; the switch is logged. The model card at the bottom of the tab gives the training data, the features, the backtests and the models' limits.

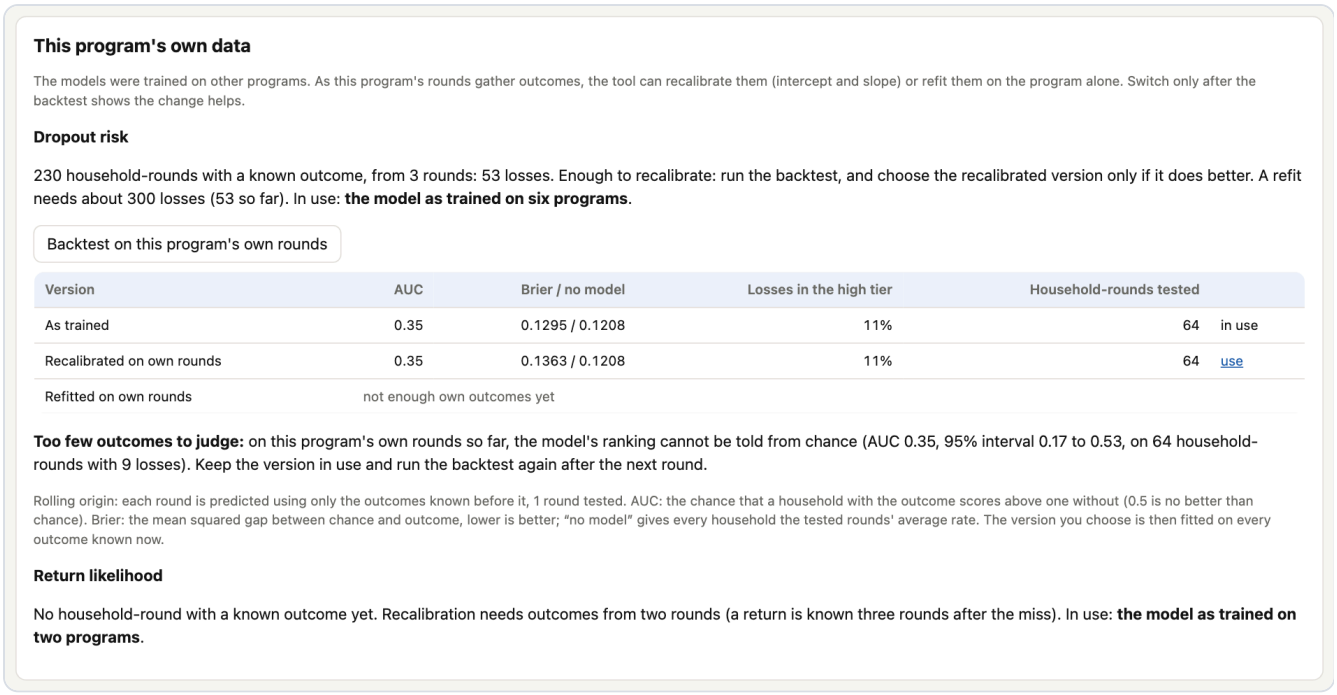


Figure B27. The own-round backtest on the practice program: too few outcomes to judge.

B19 A round, step by step

When	Leader	Enumerators
Before the round	Steps 1 to 8; give out the files and passphrases; save the session	Open their assignment; check the Today tab and the Calendar
Each working day	Import the exports; settle merge questions; read Progress	Call, log, save; export at the end of the day
When an enumerator is away	Move their households by hand or prepare an updated assignment for the others	Load the updated assignment
End of the round	Import the final exports; write the round's files; move contact updates into the household list	Export a final time
Next round	Load this round's merged files as an earlier round (step 2)	Open the new assignment

B20 Messages and what to do

Message	What to do
"Enter the rotation share for this round…"	Enter a share under the default rule; it has no default
"Set the dial cap, the program's stopping rule (step 4)."	Enter the dial cap; a first round has no earlier manifest to take it from
"A setting changed after the rule was applied…"	Click Apply the rule again, then write the files again
"… IDs were written in scientific notation…"	Update rtmtools in Stata (`ado update rtmtools, update`) and export the selection again

“No export from E07 for this round.”	Ask the enumerator to export, then add the file
A file's integrity check fails	Ask for a fresh export; choose a version for each differing entry

Part C · With KoBoToolbox, a call-center system, Survey Solutions and a calling service

When enumerators record their calls in a data-collection platform or a call-center system rather than in this tool

C1 When this part applies

Every L2 program with phone rounds interviews in KoBoToolbox, and they record their calls in two ways. The Philippines program submits its interview form once per call attempt, whether or not anyone answered. The Central Asian programs record no attempts in the form: a call-center system holds the sample, shows each operator the households to call, dials, and logs every attempt with a status code; the form records the interview only. In both cases the leader's side of this tool works the same: you prepare the round, give the platform its list, import each day's export, follow progress and move households during the round. The tool reads the platform's export as it is and writes the list in the platform's layout. Nothing is typed twice.

What a program needs: its form as it is, the household list in the tool's columns (B3), the team (B7) with each enumerator's code in the platform, and, for a form the tool does not know, the mapping of its columns and codes once (C4). Each round: write the files (B10), give the platform its list (C5), and each day drop the platform's export on the Import tab.

> **Platform codes.** Where the platform knows an enumerator by another code than their ID here (an interviewer number, an operator code such as CATI07), enter it on the Prepare tab, step 5, **Platform code**. The tool then reads the platform's records under the enumerator's ID and writes the code into the lists it gives the platform.

C2 A form that records each call attempt

The Philippines program's form asks, before the interview, the interviewer's ID, the household (picked from the sample list in the form's choices sheet), the attempt number and whether someone answered; after the interview or instead of it, the result of the call in ten codes (complete; partially complete with or without a callback; not started, callback scheduled; refused; nobody answering; number does not exist; phone off; household unknown; reference person cannot connect) and remarks. KoBoToolbox adds the time the form was opened and submitted.

Download the data (Data › Downloads › CSV with *XML values and headers*, or the project's synchronous export link) and add it under **Add platform files** on the Import tab. The tool recognises the columns, reads each submission as one dial with the result mapped onto the codes of Part A (R1: the program's "partially complete, no more callback" counts as a complete, as the program counts it), splits the file by interviewer and merges each part as it merges a CSV export (B13): unverified, cumulative, the latest file used, every merge question raised where it applies. A complete needs a form open for three minutes or more.

What goes back: on the Call log tab, **choices_households.csv** is the sample list in the layout of the form's choices sheet, one row per household and unused replacement, with the interviewer's platform code in `filter_int_id`. Paste it over the form's list and redeploy; with a `choice_filter` of `filter_int_id = ${int_id}` on the household question, each interviewer sees only their households. The list has no phone numbers.

C3 A call-center system's log and the interview form

The Tajikistan program's system exports one semicolon-separated table, cumulative across rounds: operator, household, round, number dialed, start, end, a comment and a status code (`SCS` successful, `NOA` no answer, `NOT` no time, `NWR` non-working number, `WNM` wrong number, `OOS` out of service, `ITR` interrupted, `RFS` refused; two codes without a label in the files seen are read as "other" until the program names them). Add the day's download under **Add platform files**: only the round's rows are read, the operators' codes become the enumerators' IDs, the times are placed in the round's time zone, and the number dialed becomes the household's slot (number 1, 2 or 3) through the household list, which must be open; the number itself is not kept. The Uzbekistan program's system exports a similar table with its own codes, which the tool reads too.

The interview form of such a program records no attempts, so its export is not counted as calls. Added with the log, it is checked against it: each interview with consent is matched to a completed call of its household within three hours of its start; an interview without one, and a completed call without an interview, are listed under **Needs your decision** (count it, keep it, or recode it as "other"), and the Import tab sums up the matching. Without a log, the form's export is read as the completes and refusals.

What goes back: **cati_assignments.csv**, the assignment table for the system, one row per household and unused replacement with the operator's code, the planned first dial, the numbers and the replacement links. It holds phone numbers and goes to the system only.

C4 A form the tool does not know

A file whose columns match none of the layouts above is not merged; the Import tab shows a card for it instead (Figure C4). Say whether a row is a call attempt or an interview, which column plays each role (household, enumerator, start and result are needed; end, attempt, callback, number dialed, round, record ID, submission time and note are optional), and what each value of the result column means, chosen from the results of R1; the card lists the values with their counts. **Save the mapping and merge the file** keeps the mapping in your session, so that every later file with the same columns is read without asking.

C5 A round, day by day

1. **Before the round.** Prepare it as in B3 to B10, with each enumerator's platform code (step 5). On the Call log tab, write `choices_households.csv` (a form with its list in the choices sheet), `cati_assignments.csv` (a call-center system), `households.csv` (the tool's own form, C6) or `assignments.tab` (Survey Solutions), and give it to the platform.
2. **Each day.** Download the platform's export and add it under **Add platform files**. Progress (B15), the call log (B16) and the analytics (B17) follow, and every merge question of B13 is raised where it applies: a call on another enumerator's household, two completes, a call after a move, an enumerator without records, an interview without a logged call.
3. **Part-way through.** Move waiting households (B15, *Move waiting households*). Then write the list again from the new manifest and give it to the platform: the moved households appear with their new enumerator, and a call the previous enumerator makes after the move is flagged as a double call.
4. **Next round.** The merged call log and the actions file of this round are the history the next round's assignment reads (B4), whichever platform recorded them.

C6 Survey Solutions and a calling service

No L2 program used either; both are read as their documentation describes. A team without a form of its own can use the tool's call-record form, `formats/kobo/rtm_call_record.xlsx` (one submission per call, the household picked from the media file `households.csv` that the Call log tab writes), or the same questionnaire built in Survey Solutions Designer from `formats/suso/README.md`, whose assignments upload `assignments.tab` the tool writes and whose export zip it opens in the browser. Where calls go through an internet calling service, its call log is a second witness: the example is Twilio Programmable Voice, whose Call resource gives for every call the number called, the start and end, the duration and the status; the tool matches each service call to a recorded call by the household's number and a start within three minutes, fills a call end the enumerator left blank, lists the calls to a panel number that nobody recorded, and counts the calls to numbers outside the list. The numbers never leave your computer.

C7 What the leader sees

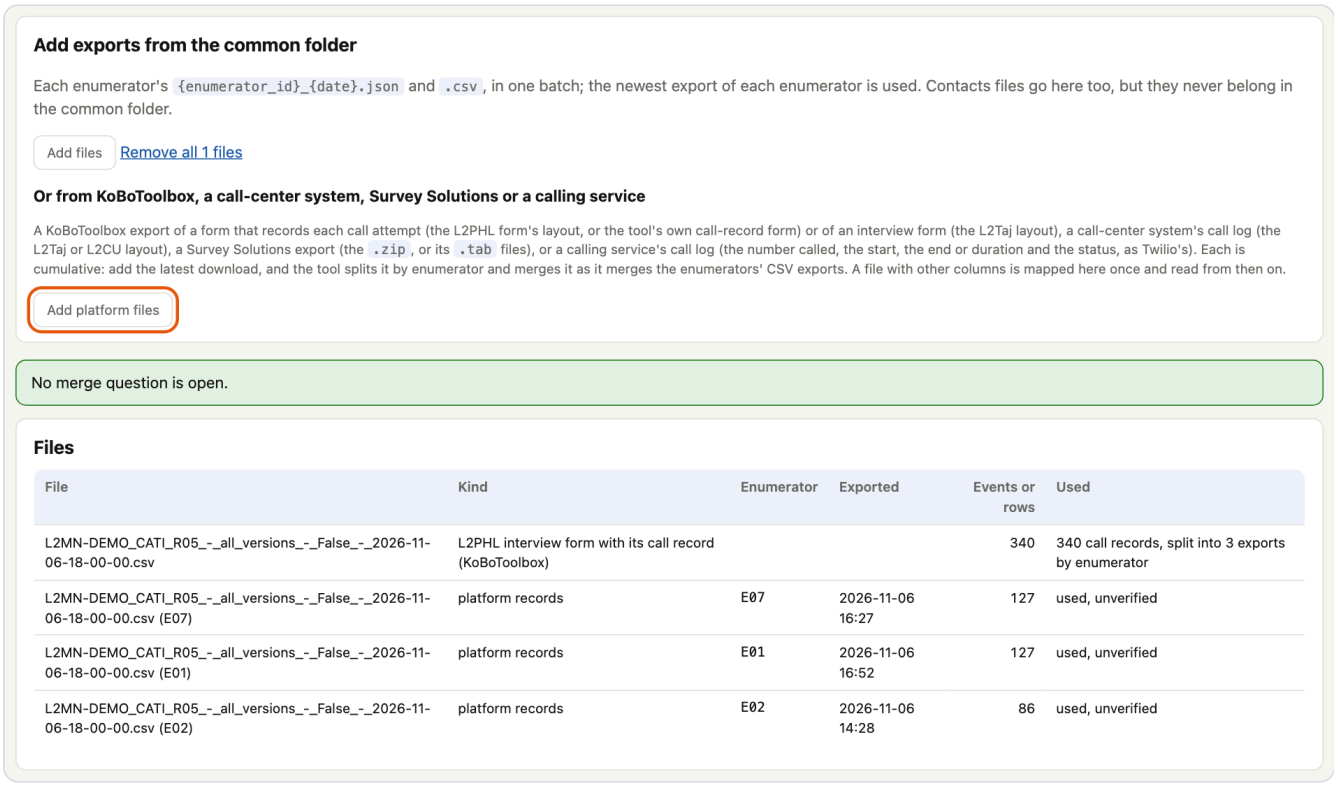


Figure C1. The Import tab with the Philippines-layout export added: the files table shows the export split by interviewer, merged as unverified exports.

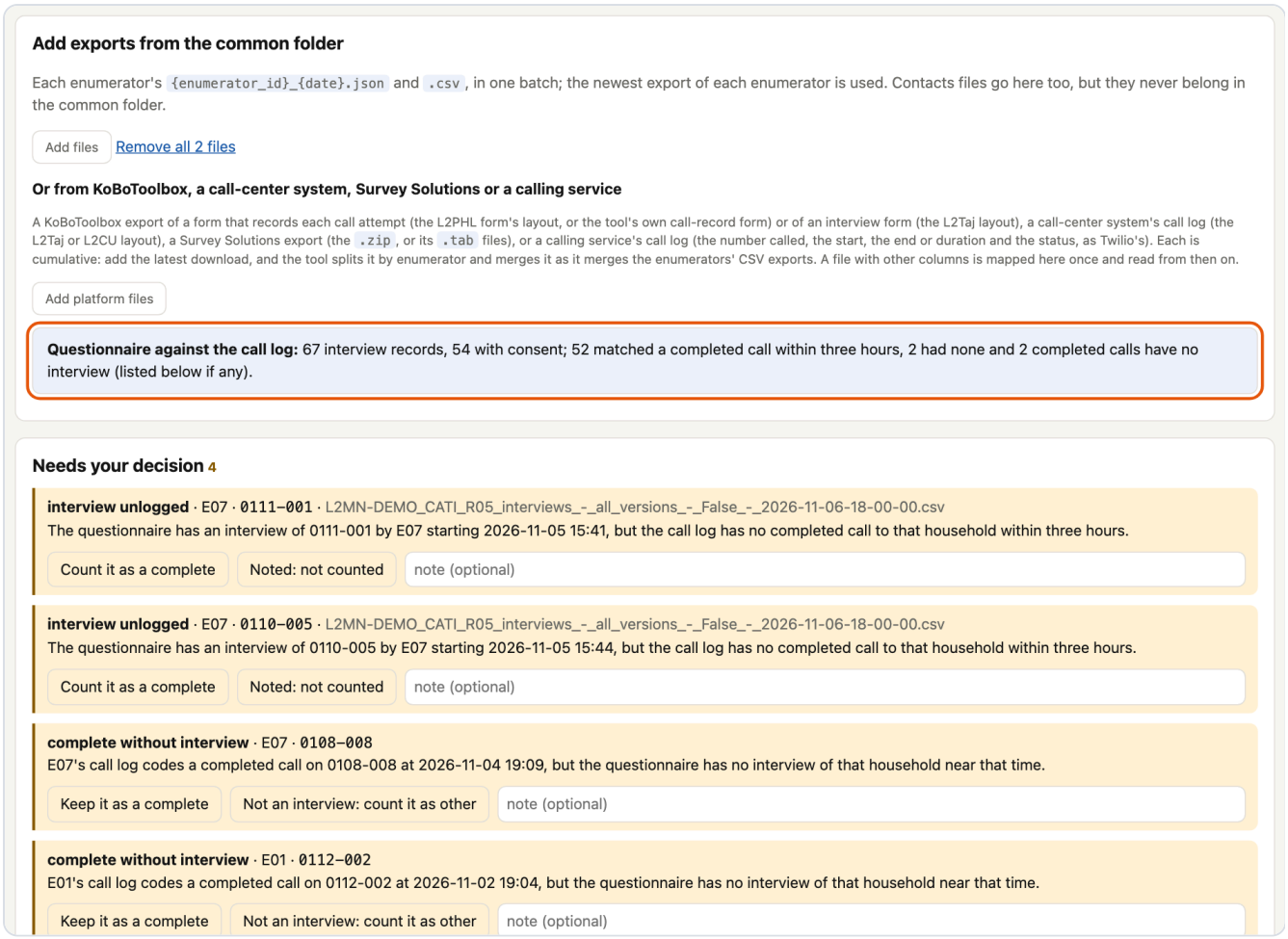


Figure C2. The call-center log and the interview form's export together: the note sums up the matching, and the interviews without a logged completed call and the completed calls without an interview wait for a decision.

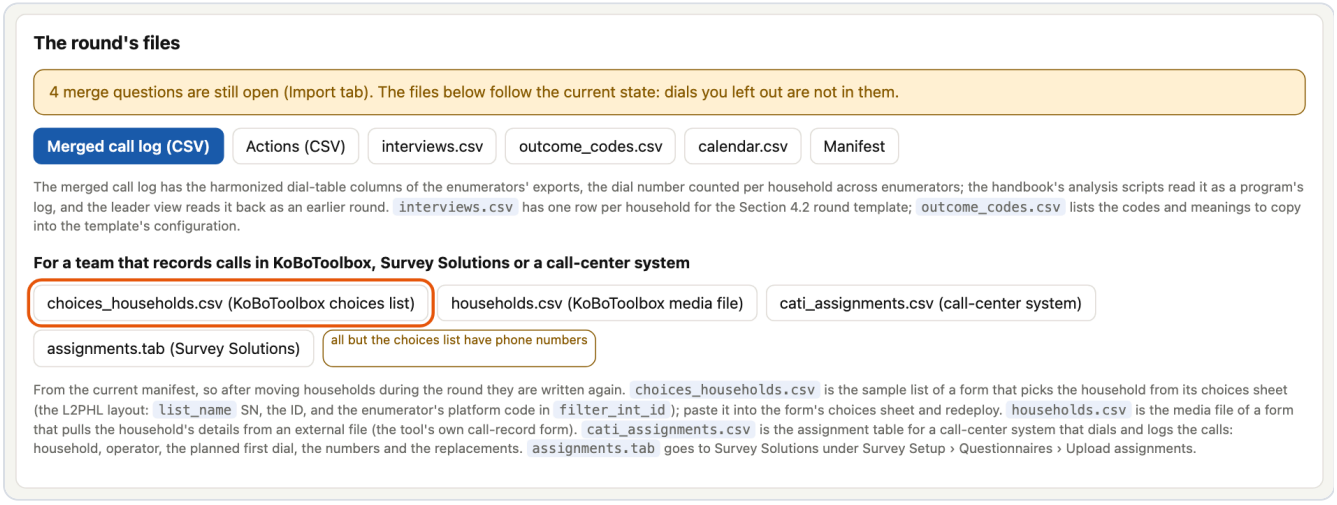


Figure C3. The Call log tab's lists for the platforms, written from the current manifest.

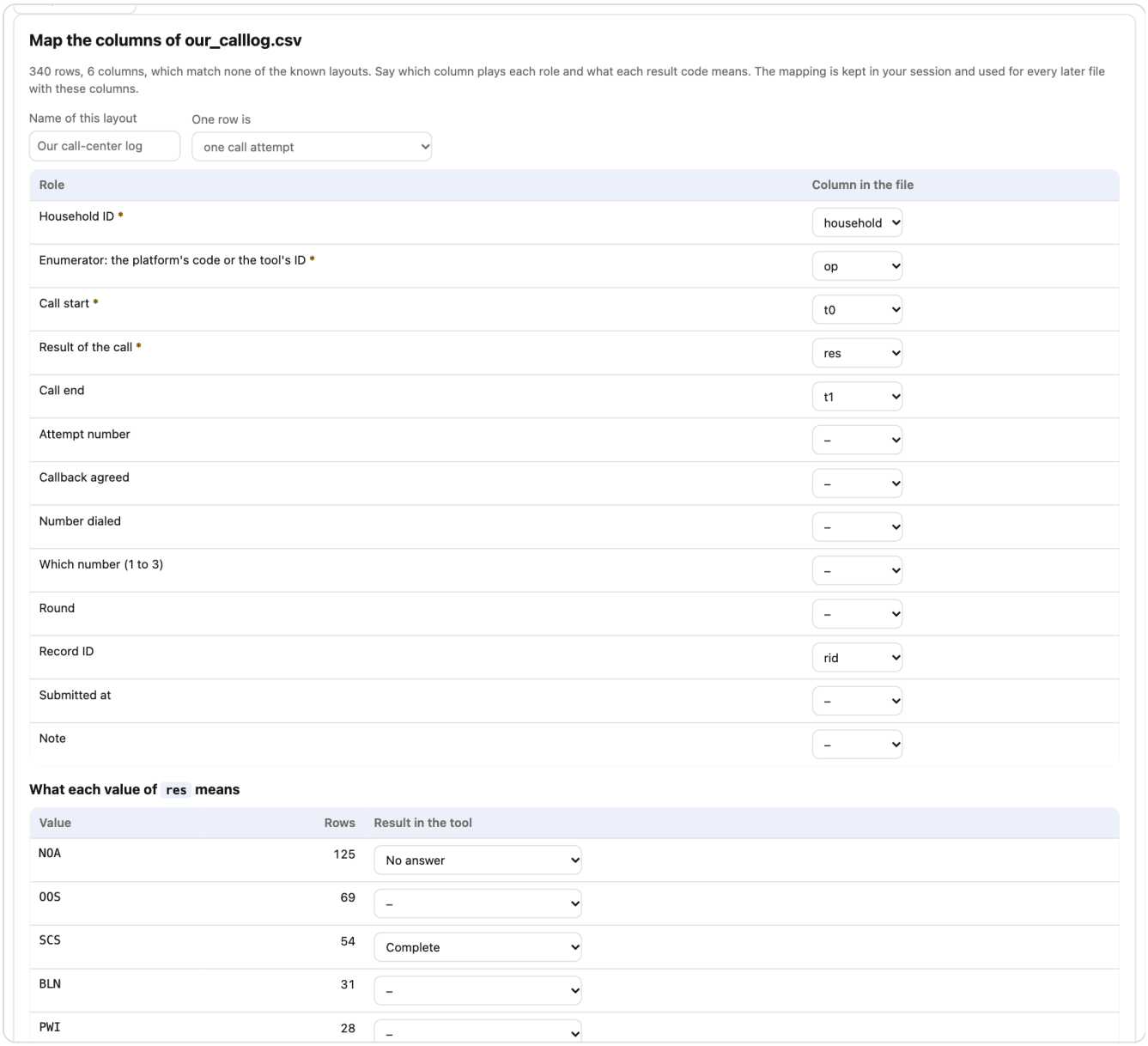


Figure C4. The mapping card for a file whose columns the tool does not know: the roles, and what each value of the result column means.

The samples: `samples/kobo/` holds the synthetic program's round-5 calls in the Philippines layout (340 submissions, the same calls as the exports of Part B) and the interview form's export in the Tajikistan layout; `samples/cati/` the call-center log in the Tajikistan layout (717 rows, 340 of round 5) and the assignment table; `samples/suso/` and `samples/calls/` the Survey Solutions export and the service's log. Every phone number uses the invalid country code +000.

Reference

R1 Call results

Result	Code	Use it when
Complete	`COMPLETE`	The interview was completed (3 minutes or more counts, Box 3.0)
Appointment booked	`APPOINTMENT`	The respondent agreed a time: enter it as the callback time
Partial interview	`PARTIAL`	The interview started but did not finish
Respondent not available	`NOT_AVAILABLE`	Someone answered, but not the respondent
No answer	`NO_ANSWER`	The phone rang without an answer
Busy	`BUSY`	The line was busy
Switched off / unreachable	`SWITCHED_OFF`	The phone was off or out of reach
Number not in service	`DEAD_NUMBER`	The number does not exist or is disconnected
Wrong number	`WRONG_NUMBER`	The number is not the household's
Refusal (may retry)	`REFUSAL_SOFT`	A refusal for now; a later call may succeed
Refusal (do not retry)	`REFUSAL_HARD`	A firm refusal: release the household for the round
Language barrier	`LANGUAGE`	The respondent and you share no language
Other (write a note)	`OTHER`	None of the above; a note is required

R2 Why a household is with an enumerator

Reason	What the enumerator reads
`keep`	Kept with you: you interviewed it last round (or in an earlier round, or you had it last round)
`rotation`	Rotation: part of the planned share moved between enumerators
`switch_hard_to_reach`	Switched to you: hard to reach with the previous enumerator
`enumerator_unavailable`	Moved to you: the previous enumerator is away
`new`	New to the panel
`rule`	Dealt to you at random, or placed with you by a block of the list, by the round's rule
`manual`	Assigned by hand
`capacity`	Moved to balance workloads
`match`	Matched to you by your leader's criteria (language, sex or area), with the household's values
`mid_round`	Moved to you during the round from another enumerator, so that the round finishes on time

`replacement`	Replacement household

R3 Every file the tool reads or writes

File	Written by	Read by	Folder	Contacts?
Household list (`.csv` or `.xlsx`)	The program	Leader	Leader's own	Yes
`selection.csv` or a replacement list	The sampling tool or the program	Leader	Leader's own	No
`E07_assignment_R05.json`	Leader	Enumerator E07	E07's own	Yes, E07's households only
`L2MN-DEMO_R05_manifest.json`	Leader	Leader (merge)	Leader's own	No
`E07_project_R05.json` (saved session)	Enumerator	Enumerator	E07's own	Yes
`E07_2026-10-27.csv` and `.json` (export)	Enumerator	Leader	Common	No
`E07_2026-10-27_contacts.json`	Enumerator	Leader	Given to the leader directly	Yes
`leader_L2MN-DEMO_R05.json` (leader session)	Leader	Leader	Leader's own	Yes
`_calls.csv` , `_actions.csv` , `interviews.csv` , `calendar.csv` , `outcome_codes.csv` , `_merge_report.csv`	Leader	The handbook's scripts and template; next round's leader	Leader's own	No
`_contact_updates.csv`	Leader	Leader	Leader's own	Yes
A platform's export: a KoBoToolbox form submitted per call attempt or per interview, a call-center system's log, a Survey Solutions export, a calling service's log (Part C)	The platform	Leader (Import tab)	Leader's own	Usually yes: never the common folder
`choices_households.csv` , `cati_assignments.csv` , `households.csv` , `assignments.tab`	Leader	The platform	Given to the platform only	All but the choices list
`_risk_dropout.csv` , `_risk_return.csv`	Leader	Leader	Leader's own	No

The file formats are defined in `formats/README.md` , and `formats/check_formats.py` checks any file against them.